RULES FOR WARGAMING IN 1/72 SCALE

Syrrhēxis

Ancient Battles

σύρρηξις · the clash of battle lines

From the Bronze Age to the end of Classical Antiquity

by Kevin Stanzione

CORE RULES · VERSION 0.1.0 · OCTOBER 2026

Contents

Introduction 3
Golden Rules 3
Supplies Needed to Play 3
Model Characteristics 3
- Unit Type 4
- Move 4
- Training 4
- Points 4
- Gear, Equipment, and Upgrades 4
- Unit Composition 4
- Special Characters 4
- Strength 5
- Accuracy 5
- Physical Aspects of a Model 5

Measuring Distances 5
Game Round Sequence 6
- Start of the Round 7
- Reserves 7
- Orders 7
- Activation 8
- Combat 8
- Morale 8
- End of the Round 8

Initiative 9
Movement 9
- Standard Move 9
- Run 11
- Charge 11
- Hold 15
- Flee 15

Action Tokens 16
Shooting 16
- Selecting a Target and Weapon 16
- Shooting Hits 18
- Shooting Wounds 19
- Shooting Damage 20
- Shooting into Combat 20

Melee 21
- Melee Hits 21
- Melee Wounds 22
- Melee Damage 22
- Resolution 22

Damage & Health 24
- Unit Health Table 24
- Health Penalty Table 24

Psychology 25
- Army Morale 25
- Unit Morale 26
- Mercenaries, Levies, and Nobles 27
- Unit Strength 27

Commands 28
Unit Types 28
- Closed Order Units 28
- Open Order Units 29

Special Characters 30
- General Special Characters 30
- Retinue Special Characters 33

Special Rules 34
- Model Special Rules 34
- Weapon Special Rules 39

Gear and Equipment 40
- Armor Value 40
- Body Armor 40
- Shields 40

Priority and Ability Interactions 41
Setting Up 41
- The Battlefield 41
- The First Player 41
- Terrain 42
- Command Hands and Terrain Features 43
- Deployment 43
- Reserves 43
- 2v2 Games 43

Building an Army 44
- List Making 44
- Trays, Scale, and Representation 44

Army Lists 44
Appendix I: Combat Diagrams 45
- Pile In Diagrams 45

Introduction

This game is a work-in-progress system for miniature war gaming in the Bronze Age through the end of Classical Antiquity. This is not a simulation for recreating massive battles from history, but an anachronistic and ahistorical miniature game meant for smashing together units from different eras and locales. The goal of this game is to utilize the large number of historical figures designed for collectors, to create a fun and exciting miniature game that has meaningful and tactical depth. This game is clearly inspired by Game Workshop's Warhammer Ancient Battles game, but seeks to take tray-based miniature wargaming a step further, using inspiration from a plethora of popular miniature and board games.

Update History

Version 0.0.1 - February 2026: first barebones version.

Version 0.1.0 - October 2026

Golden Rules

There are a few Golden Rules that should always be kept in mind when playing Syrrhēxis: Ancient Battles:

1. **No Premeasuring**. Unless otherwise stated, at no time may you use any tool, device, or prop to attempt to measure a distance before you would otherwise do so
2. **Only your Cards are Secret**. Players must share lists before the match, and thoroughly explain all abilities and equipment prior to the game, and again at any point a player is unsure.

Supplies Needed to Play

First and foremost, each player needs miniatures, bases, and then trays for their Closed Order units. Each player should decide on a value from which they each make an Army List, with standard games at 2000 points per side, or 1250 points per player in 2v2 games. Special scenarios may use different values.

Each player will need a Command deck, a set of 6 cards that they select for their army.

Players also need a measuring instrument, in Inches, as well as a Turning Template. Then they also need a decent quantity of six-sided dice. This game does not use dice of other denominations. And finally, this game uses Order Tokens to indicate the order in which they activate their units. The trays, bases, template, and tokens can all be 3D printed from the provided STL files.

Model Characteristics

Every model in the game represents some form of warrior from the ancient age, who wields Gear and Equipment into battle, with their prowess represented by various Statistics.

This is an example of what a Unit profile can look like:

Hoplîtai

Warrior

Move	Training	Points
6	7	17

Composition: 4 Ranks of 6 Warriors, or 4 Ranks of 5 Warriors
Equipment: Dóry spear, Light Armor, and Heavy Shield
Options: Replace Xíphos with Kopís sword for [1] or with Lakōnikón Xíphos sword for [0]
Gear: Xíphos sword
Characters: Lead Captain for [8], Rear Captain for [8], Musician for [7]
Special Rules: Phalanx

Weapon	Length/Range	Accuracy	Strength	Ability
Dóry	10	5	6	**Reach (1). Unwieldy (1)**
Xíphos	3	5	6	**Parrying Blade**
Kopís	4	4	5	**Cleaving Blade (3)**
Lakōnikón Xíphos	2	6	6	**Parrying Blade**

Unit Type

Every profile in the game has a Unit Type, which indicates to the player if the model is a Warrior on foot, a mounted Cavalry, soldiers fighting on a Chariot or Elephant, or some sort of Warmachine. Each Unit Type has special rules found here - Unit Types.

Move

This is the value in inches that a model can move during its activation. Quicker units can move further, but bulky armor and equipment can bring Move value down. The average move distance is 5". See Movement.

Training

From levied peasants to elite professional soldiers, soldiers in the ages past fought with a large diversity of training and tactical know-how. Training affects a fighter's ability to remain on the battlefield under duress, withstand terrifying charges, and perform complicated strategies. See Psychology for how Training affects soldier psychology, and Movement for advanced tactics.

Points

Armies are evaluated by their total points, with standard games at 2000 points per side, or 1250 points per player in 2v2 games. Each unit is composed of many warriors who each cost some amount of points, with the sum known as the Unit Total. See Building an Army for more details.

Gear, Equipment, and Upgrades

Each model in a unit must have identical Loadout - which refers to the combination of Gear and Equipment the model uses. This means that if a player building an army wishes to take an Upgrade, such as taking additional armor, they must give that upgrade to every model in the unit, unless otherwise noted.

All weapons a model is equipped with are stated in the Gear and Equipment of the fighter. Equipment must be physically present on the model, while Gear need not be actually identifiable physically on the model. Special Characters may ignore the requirement for Equipment to be physically shown, and instead should be specially identifiable as a Special Character of some sort.

Unit Composition

The unit will have one or more allowable compositions when fielded in battle, listing the number of ranks and files the soldiers fight in if it is a Closed Order unit. For example, 2 Ranks of 5 warriors mean a tray of 10 models, in 2 ranks of 5 figurines. A unit can only be fielded in these Compositions, unless otherwise stated by special rules or a scenario rule. For Open Order units, any number of models in the specified range may be taken.

Special Characters

Similar to Upgrades, a number of options for upgrading models to Special Characters will usually be available to a unit. There are two types of Special Character - general and Retinue.

General special characters can be fielded in most typical units, while Retinue Special Characters can typically only be fielded in special Retinue units. Additionally, Retinue Special Characters increase your Initiative, and only one of each kind can be taken per army, barring special scenarios. The exact rules for Special Characters can be found here - Special Characters.

Strength

This value governs a fighter's ability to batter foes in melee combat. Each weapon a fighter uses has its own Strength value, which might not be the same even for the same weapon on another profile. See Melee to see how Strength affects Wounding Rolls, and see Gear and Equipment to learn more about Equipment that require high Strength.

Accuracy

This characteristic demonstrates a soldier's lithe and accurate nature - both land blows in combat and hit targets with ranged weaponry. Each weapon a fighter uses has its own Accuracy value, which might not be the same even for the same weapon on another profile See Melee and Shooting to learn how attacks are affected by Accuracy.

Physical Aspects of a Model

Each miniature in Syrrhēxis: Ancient Battles represents a single fighting man, making this game more representative of moderately sized skirmishes, or an abstraction of what a larger fight could be. This game does not seek to emulate battles with thousands of men per side.

Here are the standard base sizes for units in the game assuming 1/72 scale miniatures:

Unit Type	Size
Warrior	20mm x 20mm, or ¾" x ¾"
Cavalry	25mm x 50mm, or 1" x 2"
2-3 Horse Chariots	40mm x 60mm, or 1½" by 2¼"
Elephants & 4 Horse Chariots	60mm x 80mm, 2¼" x 3"
War Engines	As Needed

Open Order units may use round bases, but Closed Order units should use rectangular bases with trays matching the dimensions outlined in that unit's army profile. See Trays, Scale, and Representation. Additionally, players should always attempt to have their models present all utilized Equipment on their Unit Profile. Gear need not be represented. See Gear and Equipment.

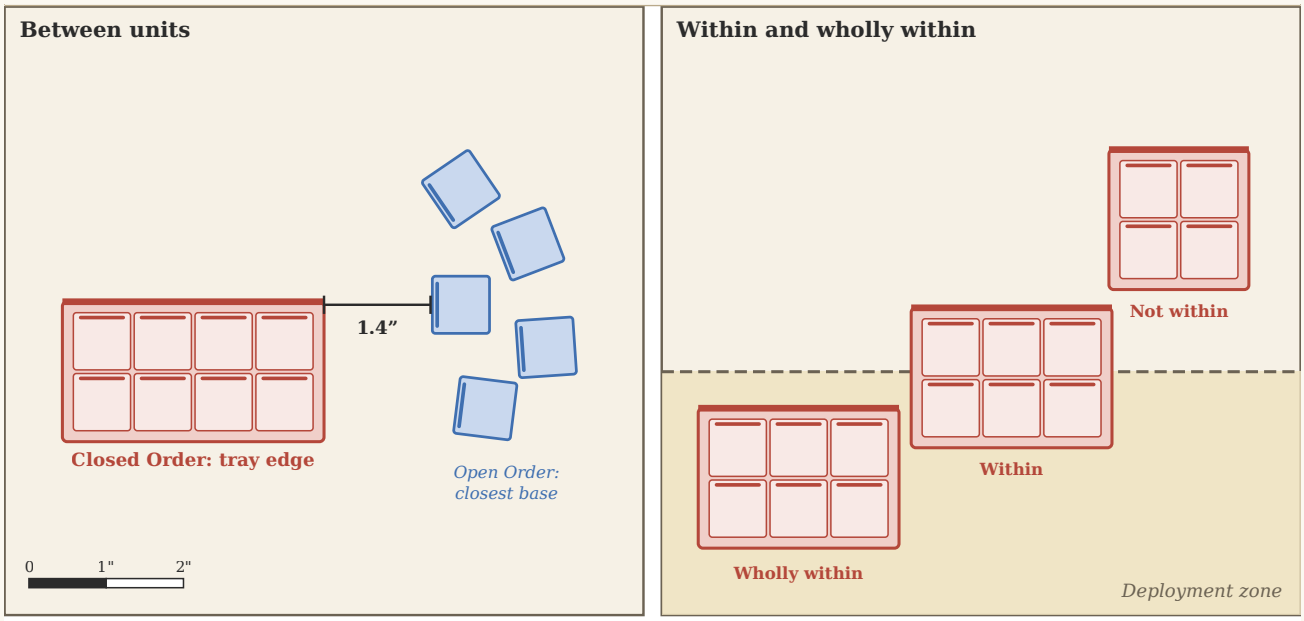
Measuring Distances

All distances in Syrrhēxis are measured in inches, and no distance may be measured before you would otherwise do so (see Golden Rules).

Unless a rule says otherwise, the distance between two units, or between a unit and anything else, is measured between their **closest points**:

- Closed Order units measure from the edge of their tray.
- Open Order units measure from the edge of the base of whichever of their models is closest.
- Terrain features, Obstacles, deployment zones and board edges are measured from their closest edge.

A unit is **within a distance** if any part of it (its tray, or the base of any of its models) is within that distance. A unit is **wholly within** a distance only if every part of it is.



Measuring Distances

Distances are measured between the closest points of two units: the edge of a Closed Order unit's tray, and the base of whichever Open Order model is closest. A unit is within a distance if any part of it is, and wholly within only if every part is.

Effects that measure from a single model, such as a Special Character, measure from the whole unit that model belongs to.

Some rules measure differently, and those rules take priority. Movement is measured from the front of a Closed Order unit's tray, or model by model for Open Order units (see Movement). Shooting range is measured between models, ignoring trays (see Measuring under Shooting).

Game Round Sequence

Syrrhēxis is fought over a series of Rounds, with players taking alternating turns as they descend through phase order. Most phases are played in Initiative order (see Initiative), such as the Reserves and Orders Phases. During the Activation Phase, players roll Initiative again to see who activates first. And during the Combat Phase, players instead resolve Melees by the sizes of the fights.

In the Start of the Round and End of the Round Phases, players take a single turn each. In the Orders and Activation Phases, players take alternating turns until they have placed or used all their Order Tokens, respectively. In Reserves, Combat, and Morale phases, players take turns depending on how many units are in Reserves, Combat, or affected by psychological effects.

- **Start of the Round**
- **Reserves Phase** - Deploy Units in Reserves
- **Orders Phase** - Place Order Tokens on Units
- **Activation Phase** - Activate Units or use Passes
  - **Initiative Step** - Determine who Activates first
  - **Moving Step** - Move a unit and activate some abilities
  - **Shooting or Rallying Step - Shoot, or attempt to Rally a Fleeing Unit**
- **Combat Phase** - Resolve Fighting Units
  - **Melee Step** - Roll Hits, Wounds, & Armor Saves
  - **Resolution Step** - Resolve Damage and Combat Moves
- **Morale Phase** - Determine Condition of Units and Army
  - Update Step - Update Army Morale and apply new effects
  - Breaking Step - Break Tests for units with Break Tokens
  - Fleeing Step - Flee Moves for units with Flee Tokens
- **End of the Round**

Start of the Round

This Phase is only used for certain Command cards and special abilities. If any players have actions to take during the Start of the Round Phase, they take them in Initiative order, otherwise skip this Phase. See Commands for information on Command card usage.

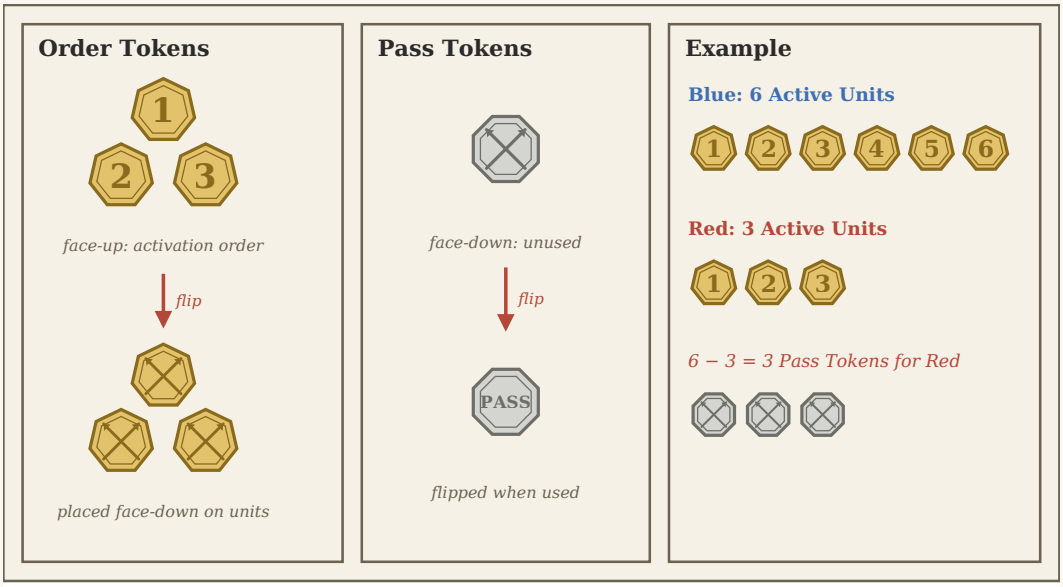
Reserves

As per Setting Up, there may be instances where a player has not yet deployed all their units. If there are no units in Reserves, skip this Phase. Otherwise, players take turns in Initiative order choosing to deploy (or not) units still in Reserves. Unless otherwise specified, units in Reserve cannot be deployed until the second round, and must be deployed by the fourth round, or they are considered destroyed.

When a unit is selected to be deployed from reserves, it is placed along its Friendly board edge, or along either Neutral board edge within its own half of the battlefield, and then makes a standard move, as described in Setting Up. Order Tokens can be placed as normal in the next Phase. Special Rules, Command cards, and Mission Rules may modify how units are deployed from Reserves.

Orders

The Orders Phase governs the placement of Order Tokens - a two-sided token that conceals the order in which you wish to activate your units. Order Token 1 represents the first unit you wish to Activate, Order Token 2 the second, and so on, in the Activation Phase.



Order Tokens and Pass Tokens

In the Orders Phase each player takes one numbered Order Token per Active Unit and places them face-down on their units, in Initiative order, hiding which unit will activate first. A player with fewer Active Units than the player with the most takes one Pass Token per unit of difference. Pass Tokens sit face-down in view of all players and are flipped face-up as they are used.

At the beginning of the Orders Phase, first all players must count how many units are currently deployed on the battlefield and not destroyed i.e Active Units. Then, they should take sequential Order Tokens for the number Active Units they have. For example, if a player has 3 Active Units, they take Order Tokens 1, 2, and 3. These tokens indicate the order in which players will activate their units in the next Phase.

Then, each player compares their number of Active Units amongst each other. Each player receives a number of Pass Tokens equal to the difference between their number of Active Units and the player with the most Active Units. For example, if a player has 3 Active Units, and their opponent has 6, they receive 3 Pass Tokens.

In Initiative order, players take turns assigning a single face-down Order Tokens to a unit. They can place any value Order

Token on any given turn, they need not place them in value order. Each unit may only be assigned a single Order Token. Once all Order Tokens have been placed, each player sets aside their Pass Tokens face-down somewhere within view of all players.

Activation

The Activation Phase is where players take turns, back and forth, activating their units, until all Order Tokens and Passes have been turned face-up. First, they determine Initiative, as explained under Initiative.

Starting with the player with the greatest Initiative result, players take turns activating units by flipping their lowest value face-down Order Token face-up or declaring a Pass and flipping a Pass Token face-up. Players may not activate units out of order, unless otherwise stated. See Initiative for how to determine results.

A unit's activation has two steps. First it moves, either together as a Closed Order unit or individually as an Open Order unit; some actions and modifiers increase or decrease how far (see Movement). Then it may either Shoot, if it has Ranged Gear or Equipment (see Shooting), or attempt to Rally another unit (see Rallying).

Closed Order units and Open Order models may divide their move, so that they move, activate a special ability or turn, and then continue moving the rest of their allowed distance. Each part of a divided move is rounded up to the nearest inch. For example, if a unit with a Move Value of 5 moves 3.1" before activating an ability, it has spent 4" and can move only 1" more. Turning may also use up Move Allowance (see Turning). A unit may not move during the Shooting step without a special ability.

Depending on which action the unit took, grab the appropriate token and place it besides the face-up Order Token. And then once the player finishes activating their unit, continue in Initiative Order to the next player's turn to activate. Units with Hold tokens from the previous round remove them before continuing with their newly selected action.

A unit with a Flee Action Token does not choose an action and gains no new Action Token. At the start of its activation it attempts to Rally itself, and if it does not, it Flees (see Flee Action Token). A unit that is Rallied before it activates takes its turn as normal.

Combat

After all units have activated, play proceeds to the Combat Phase. This Phase consists of two steps: Melee and Resolution. In The Melee Step, players determine the number of Melees that have occurred, using the rules from Melee to determine which units are locked into fighting. Then, starting with the Melee with the greatest total Unit Strength (if Melees are tied, the player first in Initiative order chooses which to resolve first), players will resolve their attacks by rolling to Hit, Wound, and Save. After each Melee is resolved, continue to the next Melee with the next greatest total Unit Strength.

In the Resolution Step, units that took Damage will lose Army Morale and resolve effects related to Unit Health. Then, the winning side may end up making some Combat Moves. See the Resolution rules section for details.

Morale

Successes and losses in the Activation and Combat Phases shape the fighting spirit of each player's army. This is tracked as Army Morale. During this phase, players will take tests and apply modifiers depending on how their units are holding up

In Initiative order, each player will take a turn to proceed through a series of steps in the Morale Phase - Update, Breaking, and Fleeing. In the Update Step, players who have suffered large losses across their armies will apply penalties to their units and have a chance to completely rout. In the Breaking Step, units with Break Tokens will take Break Tests to determine if they stand firm or flee. In the Fleeing Step, units with Flee Tokens will perform mandatory movement as they run to safety.

End of the Round

Some abilities and Command effects only last through the End of the Round Phase. Remove all tokens on the board that persist through the Round, such as Order Tokens, Charge Tokens, and so on. Hold and Flee tokens are not removed at The End of the Round Phase. Command cards cannot be activated during End of the Round.

Play continues onto the next round, starting again at the Start of the Round Phase. Most missions keep track of the number of Rounds that have passed - note the passing of each Round in some place visible to all players.

Initiative

After players have placed all their Order Tokens, they proceed to the beginning of the Activation Phase and determine the order of Initiative for the round. Each player rolls 1d6, adding any bonuses they may have from command cards or effects. If players tie, the tied players roll again, adding the same bonuses, until the tie is broken.

The result, from highest to lowest, is the Initiative order. Whenever a rule says to act in Initiative order, use the most recent Initiative roll: the Start of the Round, Reserves and Orders Phases use the previous round's roll, while the Activation, Combat and Morale Phases use this round's. In the first round, before Initiative has been rolled, the First Player goes first.

Movement

Every unit profile in the game has a Movement Value - a number in inches that dictates the normal distance the unit can travel in combat.

When a unit is activated, during the Movement step it takes one action. Normally the controlling player chooses one of four actions: Standard Move, Run, Charge, or Hold. A unit with a Flee Action Token does not choose: it must take the Flee action instead. Every action except Standard Move gives the unit the Action Token of the same name (see Action Tokens). The token reminds both players what the unit did, because it changes how the unit attacks and defends. The table below summarizes the five actions.

Action	What it does
Standard Move	Move up to the unit's Move value, turning as needed, without ending within 1" of an enemy unit. The unit may shoot afterwards. No Action Token.
Run	Move up to twice the Move value. Gains a Run Action Token: -1 Strength, and the unit cannot shoot.
Charge	Move up to twice the Move value into contact with an enemy unit. Gains a Charge Action Token: +1 Strength, and the unit cannot shoot.
Hold	Stay in place to meet the enemy. Gains a Hold Action Token until the unit's next activation: +1 Accuracy, and +1 to Break and Fear Tests.
Flee (forced)	Only for a unit with a Flee Action Token. It first tries to Rally itself; if it does not, it Flees.

There are 3 major rules that apply to all forms of Movement:
1. No unit may overlap another unit

2. No unit may move through another unit, without a special ability

3. No unit may willingly move off the board, and if they are forced to they are removed from play

Standard Move

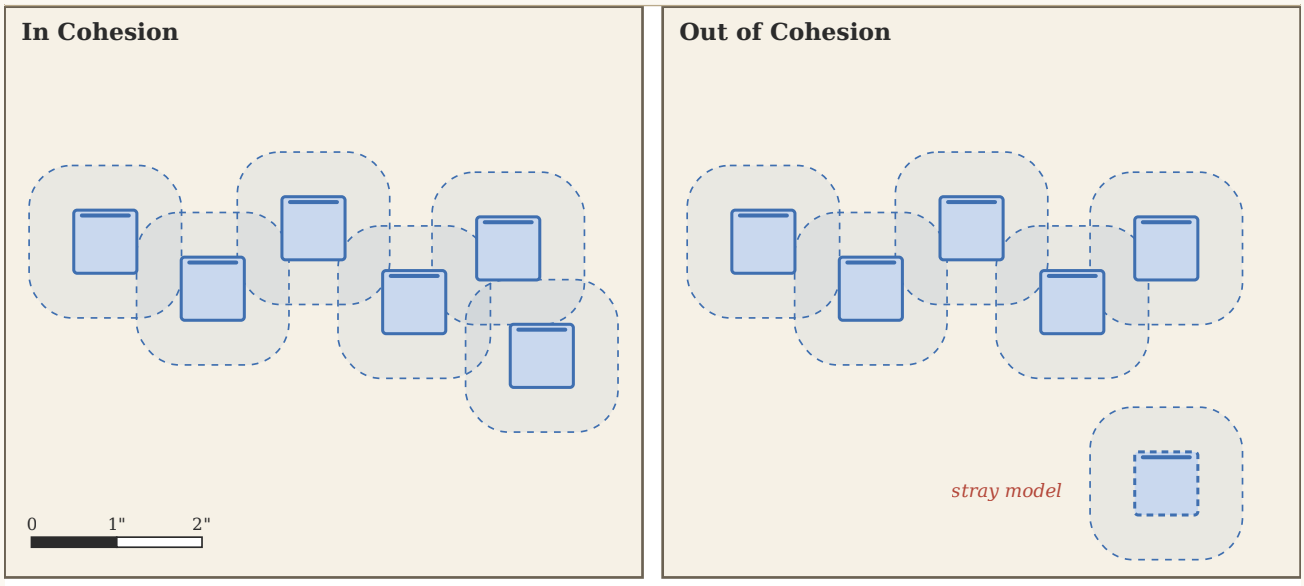
A Standard move is when a unit is most flexible - it can move, turn, and later shoot. During a Standard Move no part of the unit may end its move within 1" of an enemy unit.

Moving

A Standard Move action provides the unit its Move Value in Move Allowance. In other terms, the unit is allowed to move a number of inches this activation equal to its Move Value.

For a closed order unit on a tray, begin measuring the move from the front of the tray, and end measuring from the front of the tray. Make sure to not move the unit forward extra distance by changing the measure reference point.

For an open order unit, with loose models rather than on a tray, the models move individually but must end the activation with 1" Cohesion. This means that any given open order model must be within 1" of another open order model - either in the form of a chain or a cluster. When open order units move, you may first rotate them freely so that their front is in the direction of travel, and use that edge as a measuring reference.



Open Order Cohesion

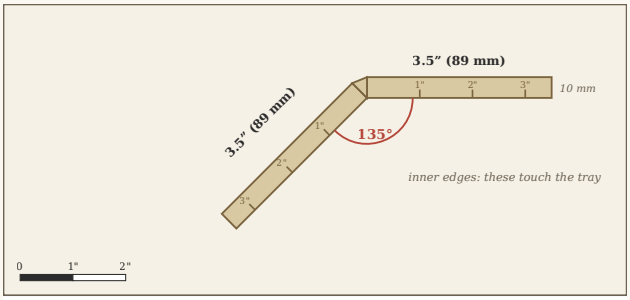
An Open Order unit must end its activation in 1” Cohesion: every model within 1” of another model in the unit, in a chain or a cluster. Each dashed halo reaches ½” beyond its base, so models whose halos touch are within 1” of each other. On the right, one model’s halo touches no other, so the unit is out of Cohesion.

Turning

During a unit’s Standard Move it may also turn. Units may turn and move in any order as they use their Move Value, and the rules for turning differ between Closed and Open Order units. A unit may stop partway through its move to turn, but each part of the move is rounded up to the nearest inch (see Activation). For example, a unit that moves 0.8” and then turns has spent 1”.

Closed Order Turning

Closed Order units turn their entire tray at once. Turning the unit is done in 45° increments using the Turn Template. Place the Turn Template in one of the front corners of the Tray, aligning one side of the tool with the front side of the tray. Then, rotate the unit backwards around that corner, guided by the template. The Turn Template’s two arms meet at 135°, so after a full 45° turn the unit’s flank is flush with the other arm. A unit **does not need** to turn the full 45°.

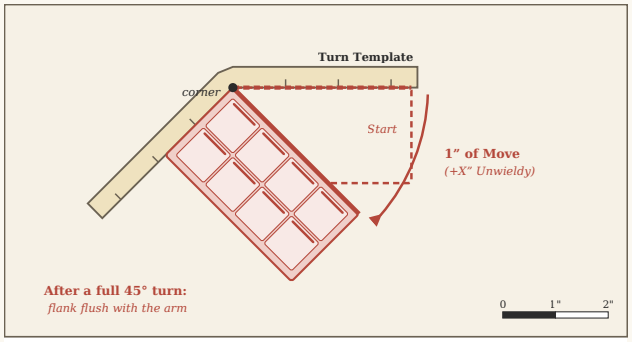


The Turn Template

The Turn Template is two 3.5” arms joined at 135°, each 10 mm wide, with a tick every inch along the inner edges. It is used for Closed Order turns (see Turning) and is 3D-printable from the STL in the trays folder.

Each turn costs the unit 1” of its Move Allowance for this activation. Closed Order units may turn multiple times in a row as long as they are in the same direction i.e. turning left twice. A Closed Order unit may not turn the opposite direction until it has moved forward at least 1”. For example, a unit may turn left, move forward 1”, and then turn right.

Turning counts as moving for Closed Order Units.



Turning with the Turn Template

The Turn Template is two 3.5" arms meeting at 135°. Put its corner at a front corner of the tray, with the front edge flush against one arm, then turn the unit backwards around that corner. After a full 45° turn, the unit's flank is flush with the other arm; it may stop sooner for a smaller turn. Each turn costs 1" of Move, plus X" for Unwieldy (X). A unit may keep turning the same way for 1" per turn, but must move forward at least 1" before turning the other way.

Open Order Turning

Open Order units turn on a per model basis: each model turns about its rough center, without any movement cost. Open Order models may stagger their moves so that they can turn between measurements, turning without restriction, but each part of a staggered move is rounded up to the nearest inch (see Activation).

Turning **does not count** as moving for Open Order Units. They are only allowed to turn when the controlling player would otherwise be able to move them. For example, they are not allowed to be turned when an opponent is measuring Line of Sight, but they are allowed to be turned during a Hold action, or while Piling in.

Run

Running shares all of the same rules as a Standard Move, with some modifications. When a unit decides to Run, place a Run Action Token next to it until the End of the Round Phase. This unit receives Move Allowance equal to twice its Move Value.

Run Action Token

While a unit has a Run Action Token it incurs several bonuses and penalties:

- Suffers -1 Strength
- Cannot shoot
  - Chariot and Elephant units may still shoot, at -2 Accuracy (see Stable Firing)
- If Closed Order, may only turn once
- If Open Order and the unit has Evasion, enemy Shooting attacks receive -1 Accuracy
- Remove Run Action Token at the next End of the Round Phase

Charge

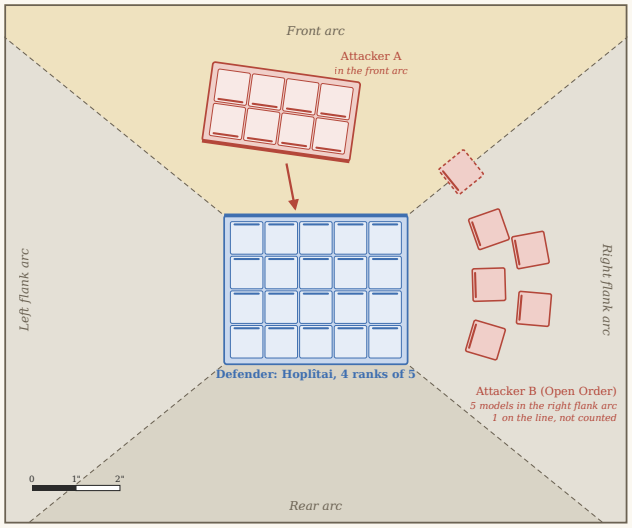
Charging shares all of the same rules as a Standard Move, with some modifications. When a unit Charges, it gains a Charge Action Token (see Charge Action Token) and receives Move Allowance equal to twice its Move Value. Without measuring, the attacking player then chooses an enemy unit to Charge. If the Charge succeeds, the attacking unit ignores the usual rule that units may not move within 1" of an enemy unit.

Charge Movement

Every Charge follows the same five steps, whatever kinds of units are involved. Only two things change. What the attacker aims at depends on whether the defender is Closed or Open Order (Step 1). How the attacker moves, and what can block it, depends on whether the attacker is Closed or Open Order (Steps 2 to 4).

Step 1: Find the Destination

Against a Closed Order unit, first work out which side of it is being charged. Draw imaginary lines through the opposite corners of the defending unit's tray to create four arcs: the front arc, the left flank arc, the right flank arc, and the rear arc. The attacking unit is in the arc it has the most models wholly within, not counting models on a line. If it is tied, the attacker chooses. The Destination is the defending unit's tray edge on the side of that arc.



Charge arcs

Lines through the tray's opposite corners split the battlefield into four arcs. A unit is in the arc holding most of its models; models on a line do not count. The thick edge on each tray and base marks its front.

Against an Open Order unit, there are no arcs. Instead, the attacking player chooses one model in the defending unit to be

the Focus of the Charge. It pays to choose one that is easy to reach. The Destination is that model's base.

Step 2: Prepare the Attacker

A Closed Order attacker may make one Alignment turn before measuring: a single turn left or right using the Turn Template, to line the unit up for its Charge. This turn costs Move Allowance like any other turn (1", plus any extra cost from Unwieldy), and it is the only turn the unit may make during its Charge.

An Open Order attacker chooses one of its models to Lead the Charge. The Leader makes the Charge move on its own, and the rest of the unit follows during Pile In.

Step 3: Measure

This step checks only direction and distance. Ignore any units in the way for now: they are dealt with in Step 4, where some can be Bumped aside. Terrain can shorten a Charge, though. If any part of the Charge would enter or cross a Stony Plain or Marsh, the whole Charge is limited to the unit's Move Value instead of twice it (see Major Terrain Types). Terrain Features follow the rules on their Command cards.

A Closed Order attacker can only move directly forward. Measure from the front of its tray. If moving directly forward would not bring its tray into contact with the Destination, even with nothing in the way, or the Destination is farther away than its remaining Move Allowance, the Charge fails.

An Open Order attacker measures a straight line from its Leader's base to the Destination. If the Destination is farther away than its Move Allowance, the Charge fails.

Step 4: Check the Path

The path is the area the attacker would cross on its way to the Destination. For a Closed Order attacker, it is the whole area its tray sweeps over as it moves forward. For an Open Order attacker, it is the area its Leader's base sweeps over.

If nothing is in the path, the Charge succeeds. If more than one unit is in the path, the Charge fails. If exactly one unit is in the path, whether the attacker can get past it depends on the attacker:

- A Closed Order attacker can never pass through a friendly Closed Order unit, so the Charge fails. It Bumps a friendly Open Order unit automatically. It Bumps an enemy Closed Order unit only if the attacking unit has at least twice that unit's Unit Strength, and an enemy Open Order unit only if it has at least that unit's Unit Strength. Otherwise the Charge fails.
- An Open Order attacker can never pass through a Closed Order unit, friendly or enemy, so the Charge fails. It Bumps an Open Order unit, friendly or enemy, only if the attacking unit has at least twice that unit's Unit Strength. Otherwise the Charge fails.

A Bumped unit is moved out of the way as described under Bump, which can still cause the Charge to fail. A unit with the Disciplined special rule cannot be Bumped, so it always makes the Charge fail. The table below summarizes this step.

In the path	Closed Order attacker	Open Order attacker
Nothing	Charge succeeds	Charge succeeds
Friendly Closed Order unit	Charge fails	Charge fails
Friendly Open Order unit	Bump it	Bump it if 2× its Unit Strength
Enemy Closed Order unit	Bump it if 2× its Unit Strength	Charge fails
Enemy Open Order unit	Bump it if at least its Unit Strength	Bump it if 2× its Unit Strength
More than one unit	Charge fails	Charge fails

Step 5: Move

If the Charge succeeds, move the attacker directly forward into contact with the Destination. A Closed Order attacker moves its tray until it touches the Destination. An Open Order attacker moves its Leader until its base touches the Destination. Then continue to Charge Results. If the Charge fails, see Charge Fails.

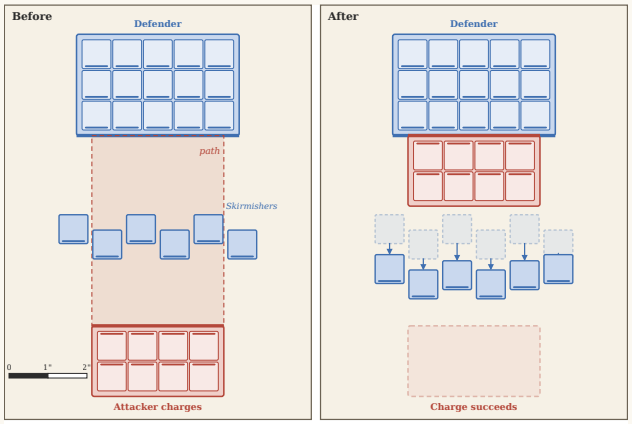
Bump

When an interfering unit is Bumped, its controlling player moves it out of the attacker's way. A Bump can still cause the Charge to fail.

A Bumped Closed Order unit may move no more than its Move Value. First, its controlling player chooses left or right and moves it directly sideways the minimum distance needed for the attacker to pass. If that would leave it in base contact with or overlapping the attacker's final position, within 1" of any other enemy unit, or overlapping a friendly unit, try the other direction instead. If neither direction works, try moving it directly backwards. If none of the three directions works, the Charge fails, and the interfering unit is returned to its original position as accurately as possible.

A Bumped Open Order unit only needs to clear the space where the attacker will end its Charge, not the whole path: the attacker is treated as passing through its loose formation. Its models may end anywhere else, including in the area the attacker crossed, so stepping back toward the charging unit is often the easiest way

to make room. Its controlling player moves each model no more than its Move Value, so that the models keep 1" Cohesion, are not in base contact with or overlapping the attacker's final position, are not within 1" of any other enemy unit, and do not overlap a friendly unit. If this is not possible, the Charge fails, and the interfering unit is returned to its original position as accurately as possible.



The Path and Bumping

Before: the shaded band is the path, the area the attacking tray sweeps as it moves directly forward. One enemy Open Order unit is in it, and the attacker (Unit Strength 8) has at least its Unit Strength (6), so it is Bumped. After: the skirmishers only clear the attacker's final position. They step back into the ground the attacker crossed, keeping Cohesion, and the Charge succeeds.

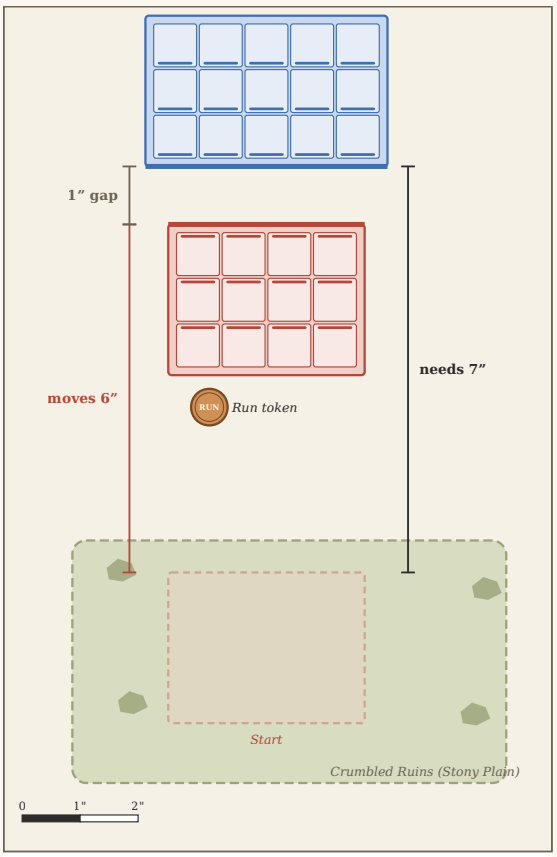
Charge Results

If the attacking unit made it to its opponent, its Charge has succeeded. The sight of a screaming mass of blades bearing down will often break the enemy's nerve. But on a cluttered battlefield, or after a risky maneuver, the attacker may not reach its target, and the Charge fails.

Charge Fails

If the Charge fails, the attacker moves only part of the way. A Closed Order unit moves directly forward along its path as far as it can without coming within 1" of an enemy unit or overlapping a friendly unit. An Open Order unit moves each model in a straight line toward the defending unit as far as it can, without any model coming within 1" of an enemy unit, overlapping a friendly unit, or leaving 1" Cohesion.

Then replace the unit's Charge Action Token with a Run Action Token, and its controlling player loses Army Morale equal to the attacking unit's Unit Strength. The unit's move ends.



Charge Fails

Hattian Infantry (Move 6) would normally charge up to 12", but they start in Crumbled Ruins, which follow the rules for a Stony Plain, so the whole Charge is limited to their Move of 6". They need 7" to reach the defender, so the Charge fails. They move directly forward as far as they can, without coming within 1" of an enemy unit. Their Charge Action Token becomes a Run Action Token, and their controlling player loses Army Morale equal to their Unit Strength.

Charge Succeeds

If the Charge succeeds, part of the attacking unit is now in contact with the defending unit. Check for Terrify, then continue to Pile In.

Terrify

A successful Charge can strike fear into the defender. Units with the Terrify X special rule give the defending unit Break tokens when they charge it successfully (see Terrify X). Large units also frighten smaller ones. Compare the attacking unit's Unit Strength with the defending unit's (see Unit Strength). If the attacker has at least twice the defender's Unit Strength, the defending unit gains a Break token. If it has at least three times, the defender gains 2 Break tokens instead, and so on, with one more Break token for each further multiple.

Closed Order units charged in a flank or the rear also gain Break tokens from Exposed Flanks.

A unit that was successfully Bumped during the Charge is also affected by the attacker's Terrify X special rule, if the attacker has it, but not by the Unit Strength comparison above. A Bump that fails, along with the Charge, causes no Break tokens.

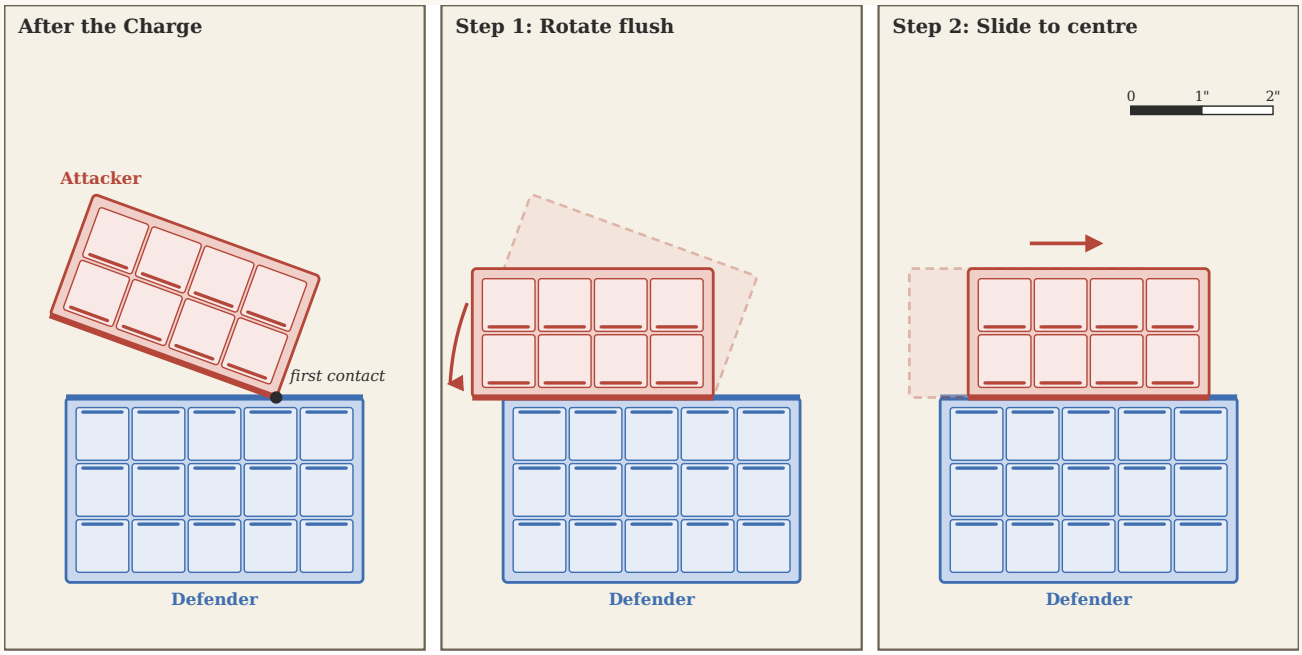
Pile In

After a successful Charge, the two units close up to bring as many fighters as possible into contact. The rule of thumb is that Open Order models move and Closed Order trays stay where they are. The one exception is when both units are Closed Order: then the trays align with each other.

Closed Order Versus Closed Order

When both units are Closed Order, the attacker lines up with the defender's Destination edge, the side whose arc the Charge came from. Follow these steps in order. Each movement goes only as far as it can without touching any other enemy unit.

1. Rotate the attacker so that its front is flush with the Destination edge.
2. If the attacker is now flush, slide it so that its front is centered on the Destination edge. If it is not flush, it may instead slide if that would let the defender rotate further in step 3.
3. If the attacker is still not flush, and the defender is not touching any other enemy unit, rotate the defender so that its Destination edge is flush with the attacker's front.
4. If the units are now flush but not centered, and the defender is not touching any other enemy unit, slide the defender so that its Destination edge is centered on the attacker's front.



Pile In: Closed Order versus Closed Order

The attacker charged into the defender's front arc and touched its front edge at an angle. Step 1: the attacker rotates until its front is flush with that edge. Step 2: it slides until it is centred. If the attacker cannot get flush, for example because another enemy unit is in the way, the defender rotates and slides to meet it instead (steps 3 and 4), unless it is touching another enemy.

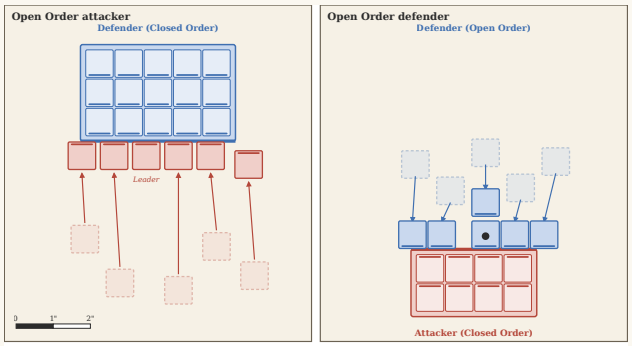
All Other Charges

In every other case, the Open Order units pile in and the Closed Order units stay where they are. If the attacker is Open Order, it piles in first. Then, if the defender is Open Order, it piles in with every model that is not already in base contact.

To pile in, move the unit's models one at a time, each up to twice its Move Value, taking account of terrain and other effects, so that as many models as possible end in base contact with the enemy unit. Models may be rotated freely, including the attacker's Leader. Models that cannot reach contact move as close as they can. When piling in against a Closed Order unit, models may only make contact with one side of it: the Destination edge for an Open Order attacker, or the attacker's front for an Open Order defender. Models may never move into contact with any other enemy unit.

The table below summarizes who piles in.

Attacker	Defender	Who piles in
Closed Order	Closed Order	Trays align: attacker first, then defender
Open Order	Closed Order	Attacker's models, onto the Destination edge
Closed Order	Open Order	Defender's models, onto the attacker's front
Open Order	Open Order	Attacker's models, then the defender's uncontacted models



Pile In with Open Order Units

Open Order models pile in and Closed Order trays stay put. Each model moves up to twice its Move to get into base contact, and against a Closed Order unit it may only touch one side of it. Left: Open Order attackers pile in along the Destination edge they charged, after the Leader's charge move. Right: the attacker charged the Focus of the Charge (marked with a dot), which stays put; the rest of the defending unit, which started in Cohesion around it, piles in along the attacker's front edge. A model with no room gets as close as it can. Faded bases are start positions.

Charge Action Token

While a unit has a Charge Action Token:

- It gains +1 Strength, unless it is within Difficult Terrain.
- It cannot shoot.
- If it is charged by an enemy unit with greater Unit Strength, remove the Charge Action Token.
- If it is charged in a flank or rear tray edge, remove the Charge Action Token, in addition to any other penalties.
- Remove the Charge Action Token at the next End of the Round Phase.

Hold

A unit that holds is standing its ground - giving up its chance to move to stand their ground and strongly oppose any incoming foes. When a unit Holds, it gains a Hold Action token that persists not just until the end of the round, but until its next activation.

Hold Action Token

While a unit has a Hold Action Token it incurs several bonuses:

- Gains +1 Accuracy
- Cannot move. If the unit moves due to any effect except alignment, remove the Hold Action Token
- +1 for Break and Fear tests
- Remove Hold Action token at the beginning of the next activation

Flee

Fleeing is an action players will avoid but are sometimes forced to take. If a unit begins its activation with a Flee Action Token, it will attempt to Rally itself otherwise it will run from combat. See Rallying for more details.

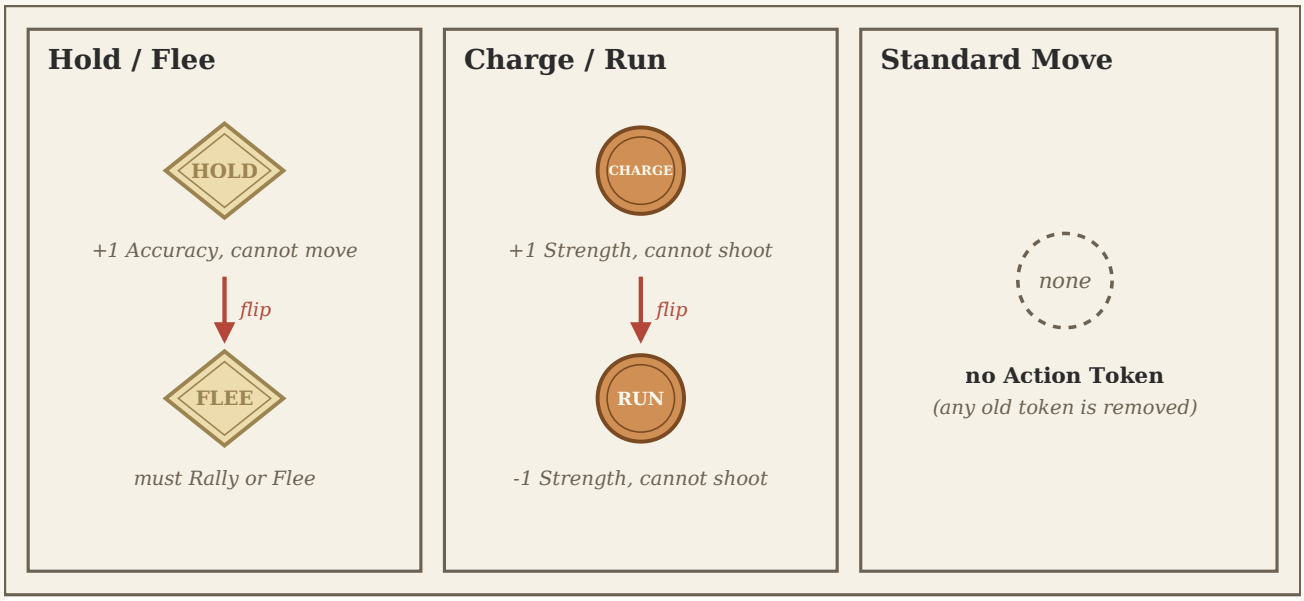
Flee Action Token

While a unit has a Flee Action Token, it incurs several penalties:

- Enemy attacks against the unit gain +1 Strength
- At the beginning of this unit's activation, it first attempts to Rally itself, if possible
- If the unit does not Rally itself, it Flees. See Fleeing
- Fleeing units cannot shoot
  - Chariot and Elephant units may still shoot, at -2 Accuracy (see Stable Firing)
- Unit cannot take any movement action except Flee, removes any other Action Token except Flee, and keeps this Action Token until the unit Rallies
- If a Fleeing unit wins a Melee, during the Resolution the unit must Withdraw as far back as possible.

Action Tokens

There are five Movement Actions, but only four of them grant a movement Action Token: Run, Charge, Hold, and Flee. Standard Move does not grant any Action Token. When a unit takes a Movement Action, it should remove whatever Action Token it previously had (if any) and then place the corresponding token for its new action. A Unit may never have more than one Action Token, and in several instances it may lose Action Tokens (or ignore certain effects due to game rules and special abilities). Units do not begin play with any Action Tokens, unless otherwise stated.



Action Tokens

Every action except Standard Move gives the unit an Action Token, placed beside it. Hold and Flee share one diamond token, and Charge and Run share one round token, flipped to the side that applies. A unit never has more than one Action Token.

Shooting

After the Movement Step, the activated unit will proceed to the Shooting Step. During this Step, the unit may use its missile weapons to attack enemies at range. Units may not shoot if they are Locked in Combat or have a Run, Flee, or Charge Action Token, unless otherwise stated. Keep in mind that Shooting attacks uniquely cause Suppression - meaning that even hits that don't wound will cause the enemy to lose morale.

A unit that moved during its activation, including turning, shoots at -1 Accuracy. Every bonus and penalty to Shooting is explained in Shooting Modifiers, and summarized in the Shooting Accuracy Modifiers Table.

Selecting a Target and Weapon

Before measuring, the player controlling the activated unit must first select a target they believe to be in range. The player also chooses at this time which weapon they are wishing to use for their shooting attacks. Players may not target friendly units with shooting attacks, and they may not target units Locked in Combat with friendly units either.

Measuring

Each ranged weapon has a Range Value in inches (“). Use the Range Value of the weapon selected before measuring as the

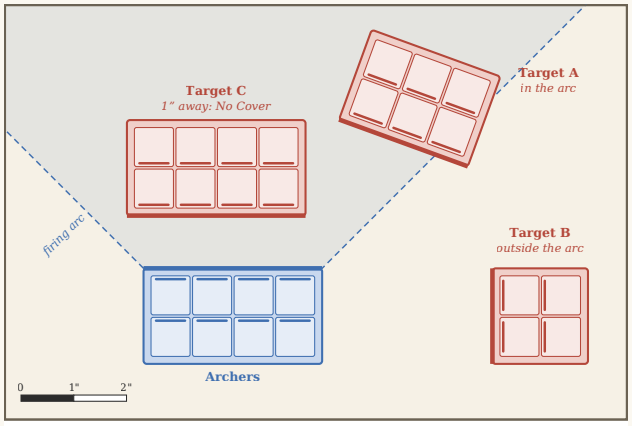
maximum distance for missile attacks, unless modified by special rules. Begin by measuring from any point on any model in the attacking unit to any point on any model in the defending unit, disregarding trays Closed Order units are on. If the shortest distance measured this way is greater than the Range Value of the attacking units selected weapon, the shooting attack fails. Otherwise, proceed to checking for Line of Sight.

Line of Sight

Determine what fraction of your unit has a clear line of sight to the defending unit - get physically behind the models and attempt to see from the view of the attacking models. For each model, determine if it can see at least 50% or more of the enemy unit. Models in the same unit cannot be considered as blocking Line of Sight for this purpose, but other things can, such as friendly units, enemy units, or battlefield objects and terrain. When working out how much of the target each model can see, only terrain, units, and other objects between them block its view. The direction a model faces does not. If no model in the attacking unit can see the target, the unit cannot shoot at it.

Firing Angle

Closed Order units must also consider Firing Angle, which decides whether the unit may shoot at a target at all. A Closed Order unit's firing arc is the area in front of its tray between two lines running out at 45° from its front corners. It may only shoot at an enemy unit that is at least partly within this arc, so a Closed Order unit cannot fire sideways or backwards without turning its tray. Firing Angle does not affect Line of Sight or Cover: once the target is within the arc, every model in the unit checks its view of the target as normal.



Firing Angle

A Closed Order unit may only shoot at an enemy unit that is at least partly within its firing arc: the area in front of its tray between two lines running out at 45° from its front corners. Targets A and C are in the arc; Target B is level with the unit's flank, so the unit must turn to shoot it. Firing Angle never gives Cover: Target C, just 1" away with nothing between them, has No Cover.

Determine Cover

If the attacking unit has an obstructed view of the defending unit, consult the below table.

		% Attacking Unit Can See			
		100%	≥50%	≥25%	<25%
% Defending Unit Seen	100%	No Cover	Light Cover	Cover	Heavy Cover
	≥50%	Light Cover	Cover	Heavy Cover	Cannot Shoot
	≥25%	Cover	Heavy Cover	Cannot Shoot	Cannot Shoot
	<25%	Heavy Cover	Cannot Shoot	Cannot Shoot	Cannot Shoot

NO COVER

The shooting attack proceeds with clear view - continue to Shooting Hits.

LIGHT COVER

The shooting attack is slightly impeded.

- If Light Cover is caused by any friendly units, you may not fire, unless the unit is using Volley.
- If Light Cover is caused by battlefield objects or enemy units, you suffer a -1 Accuracy penalty for shooting.

COVER

The shooting attack is decently impeded.

- If Cover is caused by any friendly units, you may not fire, unless the unit is using Volley.
- If Cover is caused by enemy units, half of your attacks go against the interfering unit, half go against the selected unit, rounded down, and you suffer -1 Accuracy penalty for shooting.
- If Cover is caused by battlefield objects, you lose half of your shooting attacks and suffer a -1 Accuracy penalty for shooting, rounded down
- If Cover is caused by both enemy units and battlefield objects, determine which is closest to the attacking unit and then resolve that penalty first i.e. if an enemy unit is in front of a wall blocking the defending unit, half your attacks go to the enemy, a quarter are lost, and a quarter go to the defending unit, all at -1 penalty.

HEAVY COVER

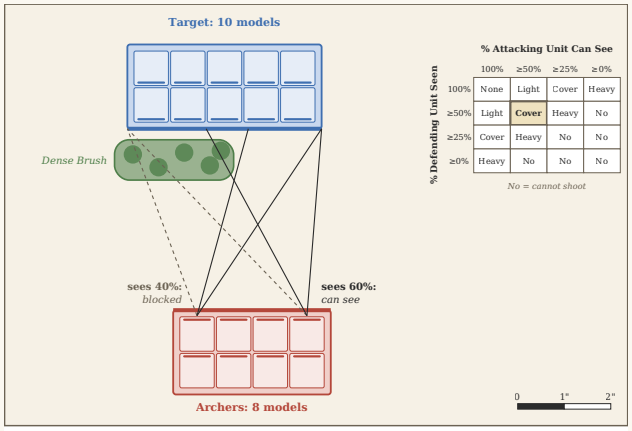
The shooting attack is missing greatly due to cover.

- If Heavy Cover is caused by any friendly units, you may not fire, unless the unit is using Volley.

- If Heavy Cover is caused by enemy units, half of your attacks go against the interfering unit, half go against the selected unit, rounded down, and you suffer -1 Accuracy penalty for shooting.
- If Heavy Cover is caused by battlefield objects, you lose half of your shooting attacks and suffer a -2 Accuracy penalty for shooting, rounded down
- If Heavy Cover is caused by both enemy units and battlefield objects, determine which is closest to the attacking unit and then resolve that penalty first i.e. if an enemy unit is in front of a wall blocking the defending unit, half your attacks go to the enemy, a quarter are lost, and a quarter go to the defending unit, all at -2 Accuracy penalty.

CANNOT SHOOT

The shooting attack fails outright. End the Shooting Step.



% Attacking Unit Can See

% Defending Unit Seen	100%	≥50%	≥25%	≥0%
100%	None	Light	Cover	Heavy
≥50%	Light	**Cover**	Heavy	No
≥25%	Cover	Heavy	No	No
≥0%	Heavy	No	No	No

No = cannot shoot

Line of Sight and Cover

Dense Brush hides 4 of the target's 10 models, so 60% of the defending unit is seen (the ≥50% row). Each archer checks whether it can see at least half the target; only terrain and units in between block its view. The two left-hand files are blocked, so 6 of 8 (75%) can see (the ≥50% column). The table gives Cover. Because battlefield objects cause it, the archers lose half their shooting attacks and suffer -1 Accuracy.

Shooting Hits

After determining Cover, each model in the attacking unit equipped with the selected ranged weapon contributes one attack for the Shooting Step. Some units may gain bonus attacks, and some units may have mixed equipment, reducing the number of attacks. For each attack, set aside one six-sided die. Then, consult the Shooting Modifiers Table, to determine if this attack will be modified. Note, this table references penalties and bonuses that are already referenced in other locations of this rulebook - do not count them twice, and consult their sources in the rulebook when possible for other related effects.

Shooting Modifiers

Penalties. A unit that moved during its activation, including turning, suffers -1 Accuracy. A unit cannot shoot at all if it has a Run, Charge, or Flee Action Token, if it Rallied itself or another unit this activation, or if it is Locked in Combat. The exceptions are Chariots and Elephants, which may still shoot at -2 Accuracy after Running or Fleeing (see Stable Firing), and Throwing Weapons (see below). Cover makes a target harder to hit: -1 Accuracy for Light Cover or Cover, and for Heavy Cover -1 when enemy units cause it or -2 when battlefield objects do, with further effects explained under Determine Cover. A target with Evasion that is in Open Order and has a Run Action Token imposes -1 Accuracy, and Cumbersome weapons suffer a further -1. Using Volley costs -1 Accuracy. Finally, a wounded unit shoots worse: -1 Accuracy at Weakened or Half Strength, and -2 at Mass Casualties (see Health Penalty Table).

Bonuses. A unit gains +1 Accuracy against a target at half of its weapon's maximum range or less, and +1 Accuracy while it has a Hold Action Token. A unit that uses Aim gains a further +1 Accuracy and ignores the penalty for Light Cover.

Throwing Weapons. Javelins and other weapons with the Throwing Weapon special rule ignore the -1 Accuracy for moving. A unit with a Hold Action Token may even throw them at enemies it is Locked in Combat with, at -3 Accuracy and without Aim or Volley. See Throwing Weapon for the full rule.

Shooting Accuracy Modifiers Table

Condition	Effect
Attacker moved	-1 Accuracy
Attacker has Run, Charge, or Flee Token	Cannot Shoot
Defender has Evasion, is Open Order, and has a Run Token	-1 Accuracy (another -1 for Cumbersome weapons)
Chariot or Elephant Attacker Ran or Fled	-2 Accuracy
Light Cover or Cover	-1 Accuracy, plus other effects
Heavy Cover	-1 Accuracy from enemy units, -2 from battlefield objects, plus other effects
Attacker used Volley Special Ability	-1 Accuracy
Attacker used Throwing Weapon Special Ability Locked in Combat, with a Hold Token	-3 Accuracy, cannot Aim or Volley
Using Any Other Weapon Locked in Combat	Cannot Shoot
Unit Rallied Self or Other	Cannot Shoot
Attacker is at Weakened or Half Strength	-1 Accuracy
Attacker is at Mass Casualties	-2 Accuracy
Defender is at Half Max Range or Less	+1 Accuracy
Attacker has Hold Token	+1 Accuracy
Attacker used Aim Special Ability	+1 Accuracy and ignore Light Cover
Attacker used Throwing Weapon Special Ability and moved	Ignore "Attacker moved" penalty

After determining which bonuses apply to the attack, determine the final Accuracy used for this activation, and then roll all attacks. Use the Hitting Table below to determine which attacks hit.

As long as all of the attacks are the same Accuracy and Strength, roll them all together - otherwise roll and resolve them separately.

Hitting Table

The Required Die Result columns have a terminology of X+, Lose X, and Gain X. When the table says X+, it means you must roll that value or greater on each attack rolled to hit. All other attacks miss. When the table says Gain X or Lose X, after determining the number of hits, you Gain X additional hits or Lose X attacks that would have otherwise hit. For example, if you roll 2 hits out of 10 attacks but must Lose 3, you lose both of your hits due to the poor Accuracy of the attackers.

Accuracy	Required Die Result	Accuracy	Required Die Result
1	5+, Lose 3	6	3+
2	5+, Lose 2	7	3+, Gain 1
3	5+, Lose 1	8	3+, Gain 2
4	5+	9	3+, Gain 3
5	4+	10	3+, Gain 4

Suppression

Importantly, before moving on to determine which hits will wound the defending unit, shooting hits uniquely cause additional Army Morale loss for the defending unit.

For each hit from a Shooting attack, the defending player loses 1 Army Morale. Certain units, like Elephants, may lose additional morale from Shooting hits. Suppression is caused only by Hits from the attack roll, including bonus Hits gained from the Hitting Table. Extra Hits added by other rules, such as Piercing Shot (X) or Collision, wound and cause Damage as normal but do not cause Suppression. This also applies to Melee Suppression.

Shooting Wounds

Then, for each successful hit you must roll to Wound. First, consult the Shooting Strength Modifier Table

Condition	Modifier
Attacker used Volley Special Ability	-1 Strength
Attacker is at Weakened or Half Strength	-1 Strength
Attacker is at Mass Casualties	-2 Strength
Defender has Flee Token	+1 Strength
Direct Fire, target within ¼ of max range (½ with Recurve Bow)	+1 Strength

Wounding Table

The Wounding Table has the same exact evaluation as the Hitting table, with the same terminology. Use it to determine which hits Wound the enemy

Strength	Required Die Result	Strength	Required Die Result
1	5+, Lose 3	6	3+
2	5+, Lose 2	7	3+, Gain 1
3	5+, Lose 1	8	3+, Gain 2
4	5+	9	3+, Gain 3
5	4+	10	3+, Gain 4

Shooting Damage

While not every soldier in the ancient world had armor, most had some form of protection which could spare their lives from otherwise fatal blows.

For each Wound, the defending player will attempt to save a model by rolling an Armor Save. The value they need to roll is dependent on the cumulative amount of armor that model is wearing, modified by special rules certain weapons may have.

Armor Saves

Common Armors are shown below.

Armor	Armor Value	Move Penalty	Special Ability
Light Armor	1	0	
Medium Armor	2	0	-1 Armor while the unit has a Run or Flee Action Token
Heavy Armor	3	-1	Unwieldy (1). -1 Armor while the unit has a Run or Flee Action Token
Buckler	0	0	+1 Armor against Melee attacks
Shield	1	0	+1 Armor while the unit has a Hold Action Token
Heavy Shield	2	-1	+1 Armor while the unit has a Hold Action Token. -1 Armor while the unit has a Run or Flee Action Token
Barding	1	-1	Horse armor, Cavalry only. Stacks with the rider's Body Armor and Shield

Some unit types also have Armor Modifiers, granted by each Unit Type's special rules (see Unit Types). They are listed here for reference and are not added a second time.

Unit Type	Armor Modifier
Warrior	0
Cavalry	+1
Chariot	+1
Elephant	Always 3 (see Great Toughness)
Warmachine	Special

Then after determining the total Armor Value of the enemy unit, taking into account modifiers, the defending player rolls one six-sided die per Wound, using the below table for their Armor Save:

Armor Value	0	1	2	3	4	5	≥6
Armor Save	-	6+	5+	4+	3+	2+	2+

As shown, no armor save can succeed on the roll of a 1, regardless of total armor value.

For each successful Save, the unit's armor has protected them from harm. For each failed Save however, the unit suffers 1 Damage, and some Army Morale. Track the amount of damage a unit has suffered with a visually distinct die or set of counters.

Morale Losses from Shooting

In addition to Army Morale lost via Suppression, the player also loses additional Army Morale for failed Armor Saves. For each point of Damage suffered by a unit, the controlling player loses Army Morale equal to that unit's base Training value.

Unit Health

As soon as a unit's Shooting attacks are resolved, the target subtracts the Damage from its Unit Health and checks its Penalty Category. See Damage & Health.

Shooting into Combat

Unless a rule says otherwise, a unit may not make ranged attacks into a Melee that includes any friendly units. A unit that shoots into a Melee does not choose its target: randomly select one of the units Locked in Combat in that Melee and make all of its shooting attacks against that unit, however many units are in the Melee. If a rule allows a unit to shoot into a Melee with friendly units in it, friendly units are included in the random selection. A unit that is itself Locked in Combat never shoots into its own Melee this way: it may only make Shooting attacks against an enemy unit it is Locked in Combat with, using a Throwing Weapon (see Throwing Weapon).

Melee

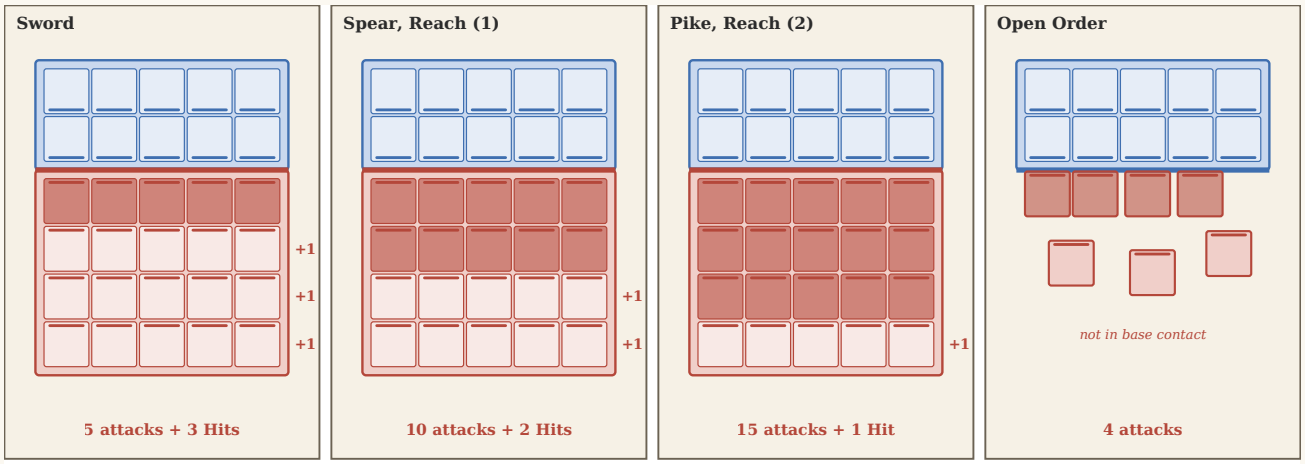
Begin the Combat Phase by identifying which Weapons the units will be using. Players take turns selecting which Weapons their units will use, in order of the longest weapon available to them. If their longest weapons are the same Length, they choose in Initiative order. For example, a unit with long Pikes must decide between their Pikes and Daggers before the enemy unit decides between the Javelins and Swords they have available.

Unless specified otherwise, all models in a unit must select the same weapon to attack during this Combat Phase, starting with the unit that selected the longest weapon.

The exception is a weapon profile that says it may be used in conjunction with another, such as a chariot's or cavalry unit's Horses alongside the crew's or rider's weapon. When selecting weapons, the unit may select both profiles together. Each profile makes its own attacks with its own Length, Accuracy, Strength, and abilities, and its rolls are tracked separately. Each profile also strikes at its own Length in the attack order, so a unit may roll one profile's attacks before an enemy strikes and the other's after. Any restrictions on a profile, such as "can only use on Charge," still apply to that profile.

Next, sides will determine how many attack rolls they begin with:

- Closed Order Units: 1 Attack per Model in the Front Rank, and in the X ranks behind it with a Reach (X) weapon
- Open Order Units: 1 Attack per Model in Base Contact with an Enemy unit



Who Attacks in Melee

A Closed Order unit makes 1 attack per model in its front rank, plus 1 per model in the X ranks behind it if it fights with a Reach (X) weapon (shaded models). Collision: each rank that is not attacking adds 1 bonus Hit (marked +1), unless the unit is engaged on a flank or rear side. An Open Order unit makes 1 attack per model in base contact and gets no Collision bonus.

Melee Hits

The unit that selected the longest weapon will roll their melee attacks first. If more than one unit is locked in combat is using the same length weapon, they roll one after another in Initiative order, but inflict wounds simultaneously, meaning do not take into the account the wounds inflicted when conducting the other unit's attacks.

First Blood. Striking first matters, because men cut down before they swing cannot fight back. When a unit strikes, it makes one fewer attack for every model's worth of Damage it has already suffered from enemy strikes earlier in this Melee: 1 Damage per model for Warriors, Cavalry and Engineers, or the full Health of one chariot or one elephant for Chariots and Elephants. A unit never loses more than half of its attacks this way, rounded down. Attacks from Special Characters are counted and lost like any other attack, but Collision bonus Hits are never reduced. Units striking at the same Length strike simultaneously, so Damage between them does not reduce each other's attacks.

For each attack, roll 1 six-sided die, rolling all attacks with the same weapon at the same time. If using multiple weapons due to a special ability, track the results of the attack rolls separately. If there are more than two units locked in combat, when rolling attacks the player may divide attacks between multiple enemies as they choose, but track them separately.

Condition	Effect
Attacker is at Weakened or Half Strength	-1 Accuracy
Attacker is at Mass Casualties	-2 Accuracy
Attacker has Hold Token	+1 Accuracy

Successful hits from these attack rolls are determined by the Accuracy of the attacking model. There are various penalties that can modify an attacking model's Accuracy score. Then consult the below table.

Accuracy Table

Accuracy	Required Die Result	Accuracy	Required Die Result
1	5+, Lose 3	6	3+
2	5+, Lose 2	7	3+, Gain 1
3	5+, Lose 1	8	3+, Gain 2
4	5+	9	3+, Gain 3
5	4+	10	3+, Gain 4

The above table will determine the successful Hits from the unit's attacks. For example, with Accuracy 5, all die results of 4 or greater are successful Hits. When a table result says "Gain X," add that many bonus Hits to the total for the unit's attack. Conversely, when a table result says "Lose X," remove that many successful Hits from the total for the unit's attack.

Collision. Closed Order units also gain bonus Hits equal to the number of their ranks not contributing attacks, and lose them while engaged on a flank or rear. See Collision under Closed Order Units.

Melee Wounds

For each successful Hit, the player will now roll to determine successful Wounds. Again, separate Hits that are from different weapons or against different enemy units.

Condition	Modifier
Attacker is at Weakened or Half Strength	-1 Strength
Attacker is at Mass Casualties	-2 Strength
Defender has Flee Token	+1 Strength
Attacker has Charge Token (not in Difficult Terrain)	+1 Strength
Cavalry or Chariot attacker has Charge Token (Momentum)	+1 Strength more
Attacker has Run Token	-1 Strength

Successful Hits use the weapon's Strength score to determine the results of their roll, modified by bonuses and penalties like those on the table above. For each successful Hit then roll 1 six-sided die, rolling all attacks with the same weapon at the same time.

Wounding Table

Strength	Required Die Result	Strength	Required Die Result
1	5+, Lose 3	6	3+
2	5+, Lose 2	7	3+, Gain 1
3	5+, Lose 1	8	3+, Gain 2
4	5+	9	3+, Gain 3
5	4+	10	3+, Gain 4

Just like the Accuracy Table, the above table will determine the successful Wounds from the unit's Wound rolls. For example, with Strength 5, all die results of 4 or greater are successful Wounds. When a table result says "Gain X," add that many bonus Wounds to the total for the unit's attack. Conversely, when a table result says "Lose X," remove that many successful Wounds from the total for the unit's attack.

Melee Damage

Now that all of the successful Wounds have been determined, the enemy unit gets one last chance to save themself from harm, by rolling Armor Saves. Armor Saves are a representation of the defensive ability of the unit's protective equipment to deflect and absorb blows.

Each unit that has successful Wounds assigned to them will roll 1 six-sided die for each of those successes. Consult the Armor Save Table below to determine successful Saves.

Armor Save Table

Total Armor	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Armor Save	-	6+	5+	4+	3+	2+	2+	2+	2+

For each successful Save, the unit's armor has protected them from harm. For each failed Save however, the unit suffers 1 Damage, and some amount of Army Morale. Track the amount of Damage a unit has suffered with a visually distinct die or set of counters. Do not immediately subtract this from a Unit's Health, as the Damage suffered for each unit is needed for the Resolution Step. Keep track of the Damage as each Length strikes, because it reduces the attacks of units that strike later (see First Blood).

Resolution

After all Damage effects and Morale losses have been accounted for, the Combat Step moves towards Resolution. During the Resolution Step, each player who owns units which suffered

Damage will suffer Army Morale, and then check if their units have new penalties due to their Unit Health. Then finally, players who inflicted more Damage in a Melee may make Combat Moves.

Morale Losses from Melee

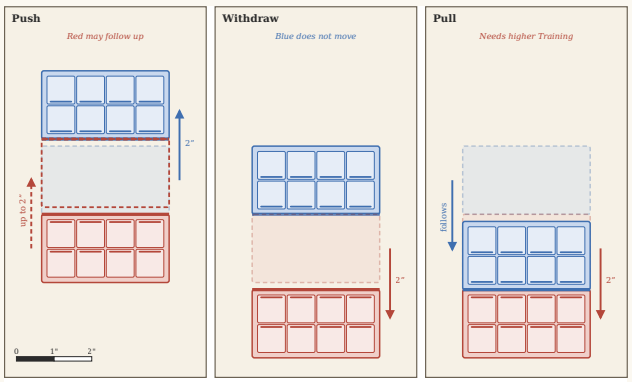
Players lose Army Morale when their Armor Saves fail to prevent Damage. For each point of Damage suffered by a unit, the controlling player loses Army Morale equal to that unit's base Training value. When calculating Army Morale lost this way, ignore any Training bonuses or penalties accumulated during the game.

Combat Moves

For each Melee, determine which player has won, starting with the Melee with the greatest total Unit Strength. For each unit a player owns in a Melee, add up the total Damage suffered by those units. The player in the Melee who suffered the least Damage is considered to have won that Melee. If the players suffered equal Damage, the player first in Initiative order wins. Some game effects may modify these calculations.

The player who won the Melee may choose to make a Combat Move with one of their Closed Order units in the Melee. If the player has multiple units in the Melee, they may only choose one of them to make a Combat Move. Open Order units **may not** make Combat Moves. The player then may choose to have their unit Push or Withdraw. If the unit has a Training value greater than every enemy unit in the Melee (taking into account any current penalties or bonuses), the unit may also choose to Pull.

Every Combat Move is made up to 2". Neither unit may be moved into base contact with any other enemy unit, and a unit that is in base contact with an enemy unit other than the one it selected may not follow up after a Push or Pull an enemy in. The table below summarizes the three Combat Moves.



Combat Moves
Red won the Melee. Each move is up to 2". Faded trays show starting positions; dashed outlines show optional moves. Push: the enemy is driven back and you may follow up. Withdraw: you pull out. Pull: you step back and draw the enemy after you.

Combat Move	The enemy unit	Your unit
Push	Closed Order: moves directly back up to 2". Open Order: its models move up to 2" out of contact, keeping Cohesion.	Closed Order enemy in your front arc: may follow up to 2". Open Order enemy: does not move.
Withdraw	Does not move	Moves directly back up to 2"
Pull (Training higher than every enemy)	If it was in your front arc: charges back into contact and Piles In	Moves directly back up to 2"

Push

Choose one enemy unit in base contact with your unit to Push.

A Closed Order enemy unit moves directly backwards up to 2". It may not be moved into base contact with any unit that is not friendly to it. If it was in your unit's front arc and your unit is not in base contact with any other unit, your unit may then follow up, moving directly forward up to 2". It may move back into base contact with the unit it pushed, but not with any other enemy unit.

An Open Order enemy unit moves its models up to 2" each, so that none of them remain in base contact with your units. They may not be moved into base contact with any unit that is not friendly to them, or out of Cohesion. Your unit does not move.

Withdraw

Your unit retreats out of the Melee, moving directly backwards up to 2". It may not move into base contact with enemy units.

Pull

Your unit may Pull only if its Training is greater than that of every enemy unit in the Melee. Choose one enemy unit in base contact with your unit, then move your unit directly backwards up to 2", without moving into base contact with enemy units.

If the chosen unit was in your unit's front arc and your unit is not in base contact with any other unit, the enemy unit then follows. Move it back into contact with your unit's front as if it had charged your unit, then Pile In. It does not gain a Charge Action Token. If it cannot reach your unit this way, it does not move.

Unit Health

In the Resolution Step, each unit that took Damage in the Melee subtracts it from its Unit Health and checks its Penalty Category. See Damage & Health.

Damage & Health

The Health of each unit is calculated during list building, by consulting the Unit Health Table below. Then, consulting the Health Penalty Table, determine the breakpoints for each Penalty Category, rounded down. For example, a unit with 25 Health has breakpoints at 25, 18, 12, 6, and 0, which correspond to the 5 Penalty categories on the Health Penalty Table.

When a unit suffers Damage, it subtracts that Damage from its Unit Health: after each Shooting attack is resolved, and in the Resolution Step for Melee. Remove the dice or tokens tracking the Damage, then check which Penalty Category the unit is now in, based on how much of its starting Health remains:

Full Strength (more than 75%): no penalty.

Weakened (75% or less): -1 Accuracy and -1 Strength. The unit gains a Break token when it enters this category.

Half Strength (50% or less): -1 Accuracy and -1 Strength. The unit removes half of its models, rounded down (see Removing Models from a Unit), and gains 2 Break tokens when it enters this category. It cannot Rally itself.

Mass Casualties (25% or less): -2 Accuracy and -2 Strength. The unit gains 2 Break tokens when it enters this category, and again every Activation Phase. It cannot Rally itself.

Eradicated (0% or less): remove the unit.

Track penalties with Accuracy and Strength Penalty tokens. Penalties are not cumulative: a unit does not gain them again each round, and when it enters a category with a greater penalty, it applies only the difference. Break tokens are resolved in the Morale Phase (see Breaking). Mercenary and Levy units cannot always be Rallied once they start to break; see Mercenaries, Levies, and Nobles.

Unit Health Table

Unit Type	Health Points
Warrior	1 per model
Cavalry	1 per model
Chariot	1 per Driver, Crewman, and Horse
Elephant	6 per Elephant
Warmachine	1 per Engineer

Health Penalty Table

Health %	Category	Effect
Greater Than 75%	Full Strength	No penalty, prepare for battle!
75% or less	Weakened	-1 Accuracy, -1 Strength. Gain a Break token when entering this category
50% or less	Half Strength	-1 Accuracy, -1 Strength. Remove half (rounded down) of the models in this unit. Gain 2 Break tokens when entering this category. Cannot Rally itself.
25% or less	Mass Casualties	-2 Accuracy, -2 Strength. Gain 2 Break tokens when entering this category, and every Activation phase. Cannot Rally itself.
0% or less	Eradicated	Remove unit

Removing Models from a Unit

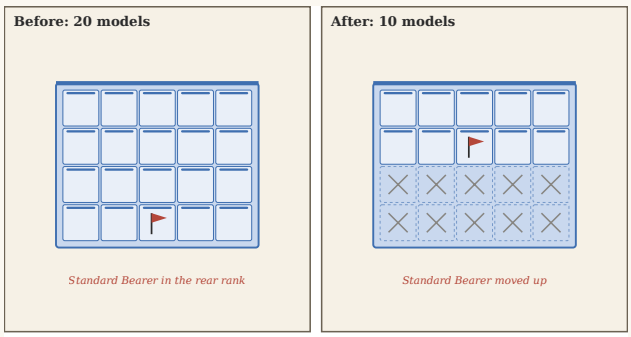
Units remove models at only two points: when they enter Half Strength, and when they are Eradicated. In between, a unit keeps fighting with the models it has, even as it continues to lose Health.

When a unit enters Half Strength, remove half of its models, rounded down, so that a unit never loses more than half of its models this way. Special Characters are never removed.

Closed Order units remove models from their rear rank first, working forward. If this leaves the rear rank incomplete, the unit keeps fighting with an incomplete rear rank. If a Special Character would be removed, remove another model instead and move the Special Character into its place.

Chariot units remove half of their chariots, along with their crews and horses, and Warmachine units remove half of their Engineers.

For Open Order units, the controlling player chooses which models to remove. If this leaves the unit out of Cohesion, it follows the normal rules for Open Order units not in Cohesion.



Removing Models at Half Strength

When a unit enters Half Strength it removes half its models, rounded down, starting from the rear rank and working forward. Special Characters are never removed: if one would be, remove another model instead and move the character into its place. Here a unit of 20 removes 10. Its Standard Bearer, in the rear rank, moves forward into the second rank.

Psychology

The fighting spirit of a warrior can be bolstered and broken through many different game rules and effects. Whether urged forward by the sight of their leaders and army's great banner, or sent scurrying due to overwhelming losses, the psychology of a fighting soldier is dependent upon how well the general controls the battle.

Psychology is broken up into two different categories - Army Morale and Unit Morale. Army Morale is reduced by enemy attacks, through Shooting hits and Damage suffered. Unit Morale is affected by Break Tokens, which force the unit to take Break tests.

Army Morale

Army Morale is a way to represent the determination and bravery of the warriors on the battlefield.

Before the game begins, each player will determine their Starting Army Morale. This value is the sum of the Training Values of every model in their army list. For each unit, multiply their Training Value by the number of models - not their Unit Strength. For Chariot and Elephant units, count each driver, mahout, and crewman as a model; horses and elephants do not count. And then sum the values generated by each unit in the army list.

Effects that give bonuses for Break tests, grant Training bonuses based on placement on the battlefield, or other effects that do not affect the unit's Training score when off the battlefield do not modify Army Morale generated.

Army Morale is lost from Hits from Shooting Attacks, and Damage from Shooting and Melee Attacks. Army Morale can also be lost by failing a Charge, and by special abilities.

Losing Army Morale. Whenever a unit suffers Damage for any reason, its controller loses Army Morale for that Damage as normal. Whenever a unit is destroyed or leaves the battlefield for any reason, including a Reserve unit destroyed for not arriving by the fourth round, its controller loses the rest of the Army Morale that unit contributed at the start of the game.

Update

The Morale Phase begins with the Update Step. During this step, each player will determine what category on the below Army Morale Table that their force is currently in. Divide the current Army Morale of each player's army by their Starting Army Morale to determine the Morale % and matching Category. Apply Training Penalty tokens as needed as the army suffers due to the accumulated Morale losses. A player with no units left on the battlefield is also Completely Routed, even if they still have units in Reserve.

These penalties have no effect on Army Morale generated or lost by Damage or other effects. For example, a unit suffering from Unease does not lose the army 1 less Army Morale per model lost due to Damage. The amount lost is the base Training score of the model.

Army Morale Penalty Table

Morale %	Category	Effect
Greater Than 75%	Holding Strong	No penalties, hold fast warriors!
75% or less	Unease	-1 Training to Mercenary and Levy units
50% or less	Panic	-1 Training to all units
25% or less	Mass Panic	-2 Training to all units. Mercenary and Levy units automatically fail Break Tests and cannot be Rallied
0% or less	Complete Rout	Lose

Unit Morale

Unit Morale is tracked by a unit's Training value and by Break tokens. Training represents not just the martial prowess drilled into a fighter, but also that unit's ability to remain fighting amongst the terrifying chaos of the battlefield.

Units can gain Break tokens several different ways. Units can be Terrified by larger or horrifying foes, which might cause them to Break. Closed order units can be flanked from their sides or from their rears, causing them to gain Break tokens. Units that are greatly wounded will gain Break tokens, and these tokens can also be gained from special abilities.

Breaking

During this step, every unit with any Break tokens takes a Break test. The first Break token is free: for each Break token after the first, they take a -1 penalty to the test. To avoid breaking, the unit rolls 1d6 + their Training Value and must total 7 or higher. If they pass, remove all Break tokens.

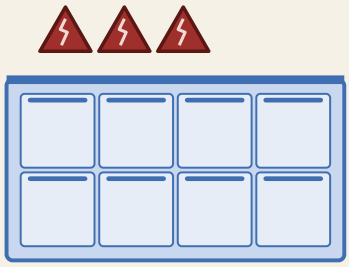
If they fail the test, remove any Action and Break Tokens next to them and attach a Flee Token to that unit. It does not lose Army Morale yet; that happens in the Fleeing Step.

Break Token



one per effect; tokens stack

Example: Training 6, three Break Tokens



Test: 1d6 + 6 - 2 ≥ 7

so a roll of 3 or more passes

Pass: remove all Break Tokens

Fail: remove its Action and Break Tokens, add Flee



Break Tokens and Break Tests

Break Tokens come from Terrify, charges into a flank or rear, and other effects. In the Morale Phase, a unit with any Break Tokens rolls 1d6 + Training, at -1 for each Break Token after the first, and needs 7 or more. If it passes, all its Break Tokens are removed. If it fails, its Action and Break Tokens are replaced with a Flee Token.

Fear Tests

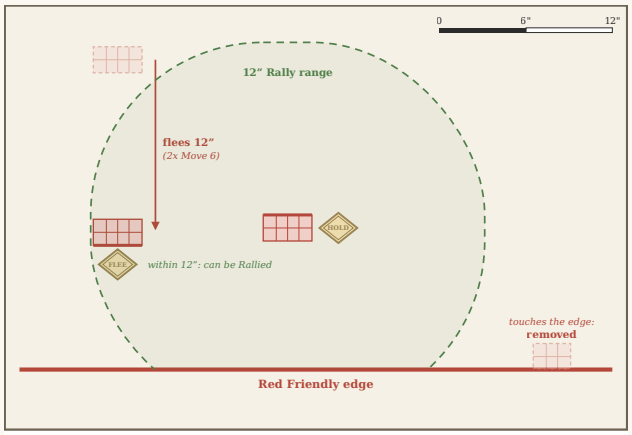
Some effects force a unit to take a Fear Test. To pass, the unit rolls 1d6 + its Training Value, minus the number of Break Tokens on the unit, and must total 7 or higher. Unlike a Break Test, every Break Token counts against a Fear Test, including the first. A Fear Test is not a Break Test: failing it does not make the unit Flee. Instead, the effect that caused the test states exactly what happens on a failure.

Fleeing

During this step, every unit with a Flee Token moves up to twice its Move value toward its Friendly board edge, and must move as

far as it can. The player loses Army Morale equal to the Unit Strength of the fleeing unit.

Open Order units not in Cohesion must move in such a way that they gain Cohesion. If they are not able to maintain Cohesion after a Flee move, the unit is considered to have run off the board and is removed.



Fleeing and Rallying
In the Morale Phase, a unit with a Flee Token moves up to twice its Move toward its Friendly board edge, as far as it can, and its player loses Army Morale equal to its Unit Strength. A fleeing unit that touches its Friendly edge is removed, losing Army Morale equal to the base Training of its remaining models. During its activation, a unit with a Hold Token may try to Rally a fleeing friendly unit within 12"; a fleeing unit may also try to Rally itself.

Running off the Board

During normal gameplay it is not possible to move off the board, but a unit that is moving due to Fleeing can run off the board. Any units with Flee Tokens that are touching their Friendly board edge or off of the Board are removed from play immediately. The player loses Army Morale equal to the sum of the base Training values of the remaining models in the unit as it leaves play.

Rallying

After a unit moves, it may attempt to Rally a unit in your army instead of Shooting. Units with Flee Tokens may Rally themselves, and Units with Hold Tokens may Rally other units within 12" that have Flee Tokens that are friendly to them. To Rally, the Rallying unit rolls 1d6 + their Training Value - the number of Break Tokens on the selected unit. For units Rallying other units, they use their own Training Value, but still take into account any Break Tokens on the unit they are attempting to Rally.

If the Rallying unit rolls a 7 or greater they succeed, remove the Flee Token attached to the selected unit. If the unit rolls less than 7 they fail, and the selected unit retains the Flee Token.

It is not possible to Rally units under certain conditions. Levy and Mercenary units have special rules that can prevent rallying, as well as other units with similar special rules.

A unit that attempted to Rally itself or another unit may not Shoot during this Activation. But it may use similar abilities in the Combat Phase when able, such as *Throwing Weapons.*

Mercenaries, Levies, and Nobles

Not every army fields them, but Mercenary, Levy, and Noble units interact with Army Morale in ways worth knowing before battle.

Levy units are reluctant conscripts. A Closed Order Levy unit does not count its rear rank toward Unit Strength (unless it has only one rank), and an Open Order Levy unit halves its Unit Strength, rounded up. Mercenary units fight for pay: they may Rally themselves, but other units cannot Rally them unless the Rallying unit has the Noble special rule, or is a Mercenary unit with a greater base Training value. Mercenary units can only Rally other Mercenary units.

Both are the first to waver as the army's fortunes fall. At Unease, Mercenary and Levy units suffer -1 Training while the rest of the army is unaffected. At Mass Panic, Mercenary and Levy units automatically fail Break Tests and cannot be Rallied, which usually means they leave the battle.

Nobles hold these units together. A unit with the Noble special rule gains +2 when Rallying other units and may Rally Mercenary units. During Mass Panic, Mercenary and Levy units within 24" of a Noble unit can still be Rallied, though they still automatically fail their Break Tests. Several Special Characters change these rules: a Lord grants Noble, a Tribal Leader grants Noble and removes Levy, and a Taskmaster removes Levy at a cost.

Unit Strength

The raw mass of a unit is important for a few different situations, such as Psychology and bumping effects. To calculate the Unit Strength of a unit, consult the table below:

Unit Type	Unit Strength
Warriors	1 Per Model
Cavalry	3 Per Model
Chariots	1 Per Driver, 1 Per Crewman, and 2 Per Horse
Elephants	1 Per Mahout, 1 Per Crewman, and 12 Per Elephant
Warmachines	1 Per Engineer, plus 3 for a Light, 5 for a Heavy, or 7 for a Massive Warmachine

Commands

When building their army, each player also builds a Command deck of 6 Command cards. Players show each other their full Command decks before the game, and are encouraged to note which cards their opponent could have, since some cards can counter others. Command cards can change the course of a battle, and some place terrain on the battlefield before deployment. After the Major Terrain's type and location have been chosen (see Major Terrain), and before deployment, each player secretly picks 3 of their 6 cards as their hand. The other 3 cards stay face down for the rest of the game and cannot be played, but some abilities, such as the Birdmaster's, let an opponent look at them.

Each Command card says when it can be played. If it doesn't, it may be played at the start or end of any Phase except the End of the Round, or between any two unit activations. Once played, its effect lasts as long as the card says.

Some cards are marked Weather. A Weather card may only be played during the End of the Round Phase of a round in which you had the Initiative, and its effect lasts through the following round. Only one Weather card can be in effect at a time: playing a new one ends the old one. Weather affects both armies alike, so play it when the conditions favor your army more than your opponent's.

Unit Types

Closed Order Units

All Closed Order units use trays, and are aligned in ranks. For example, 2 ranks of 5 warriors means a unit of 10 warriors, 5 wide and 2 deep, on a tray.

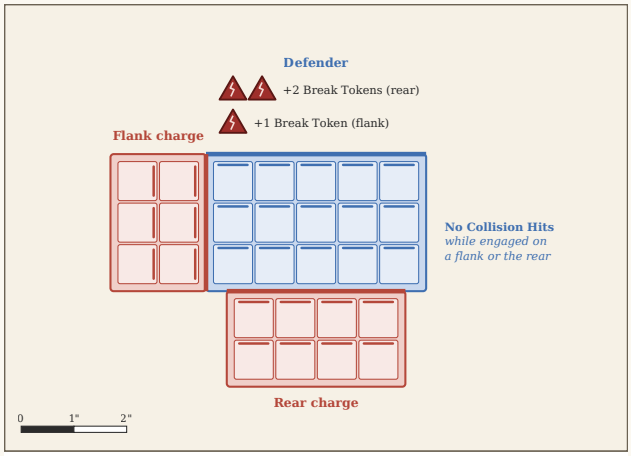
Collision

Closed Order units gain bonus Hits in Melee from their orderly formation and their ability to push. A Closed Order unit gains bonus Hits equal to the number of its full ranks that are not contributing attacks. A rank that is missing any models does not count. For example, a unit with 4 ranks adds 3 bonus Hits. If that unit uses a weapon with Reach (1), which lets its second rank attack, it adds only 2 bonus Hits. Bonus Hits use the Strength of the melee weapon the unit selected for that Melee (see Melee).

A unit loses its Collision bonus Hits while it is engaged with enemies on its flank or rear sides.

Exposed Flanks

A Closed Order unit is vulnerable from the sides and rear. When it is charged in a flank, it gains 1 Break Token; when charged in the rear, it gains 2 Break Tokens. This is in addition to any Break Tokens from Terrify. It also loses its Charge Action Token, if it has one, and loses its Collision bonus Hits while engaged on a flank or rear side.



Exposed Flanks

A Closed Order unit charged in a flank gains 1 Break Token, and charged in the rear gains 2, on top of any from Terrify. It also loses its Charge Action Token, and it gets no Collision bonus Hits while it is engaged on a flank or rear side.

Warriors

Warriors are the default unit type of this game, and other unit types are defined by how they are different from Closed Order rank and file Warrior units.

Cavalry

Cavalry units are closed order units that are mounted on horses or camels. They have a greater Unit Strength per model than Warrior units, but the same Unit Health. They also receive the following special abilities:

Momentum

While this unit has a Charge Token, it gains an additional +1 Strength.

While this unit has no Action Token, it gains +1 Strength for shooting attacks made with ranged weapons with the Throwing Weapon special rule, as long as it is not locked in combat.

Toughness

This unit gets +1 Armor

Chariots

Chariots are closed order units that ride in vehicles pulled by horses or donkeys. They have greater Unit Strength and Unit Health per model than Warrior units, owing to their large construction and oftentimes featuring multiple men fighting from atop the vehicle. They receive the following special abilities:

Momentum

While this unit has a Charge Token, it gains an additional +1 Strength.

While this unit has no Action Token, it gains +1 Strength for shooting attacks made with ranged weapons with the Throwing Weapon special rule, as long as it is not locked in combat.

Protected Platform

This unit gets +1 Armor. Additionally, the armor bonus of the chariot uses the armor bonus shared by all of the crewmen, ignoring the armor of the driver. If the chariot has no crewmen, use the driver's armor instead.

Stable Firing

While this unit has a Run or Flee token, it may shoot at a -2 Accuracy penalty, rather than the typical shooting restriction

Wheeled Vehicle

Chariot units cannot easily turn.

- Chariot units must move 1" between consecutive turns in the same direction, or 2" if the Chariot unit has 3+ pulling animals
- Chariot units must move 2" between consecutive turns in alternate directions, or 3" if the Chariot unit has 3+ pulling animals

Elephants

Elephants are powerful beasts controlled by mahouts and frequently crewed by riders with ranged weapons. They have great Unit Strength and Unit Health per model. They receive the following special abilities:

Great Toughness

An Elephant unit's Armor Value is always 3. It ignores the armor of its mahout and crewmen, and no other armor or Armor modifier changes it. Effects that modify Armor Saves, such as Sunder (X), still apply.

Stable Firing

While this unit has a Run or Flee token, it may shoot at a -2 Accuracy penalty, rather than the typical shooting restriction

Anxious

Elephant units suffer double the Army Morale lost via Suppression, and Elephant units can only be rallied by other Elephant units.

Furious

When this unit reaches Half Strength on the Unit Health Table, it gains Run them Down and Suicidal.

Open Order Units

Open Order units do not use trays, and instead move with Cohesion. At the end of any movement, all models in an Open Order unit must be within 1" of another model, in such a way that all models form either a chain or a sort of cluster. The unit may not be divided into separate groups - cohesion must continuously connect all of the models in the unit.

At the beginning of the Morale Phase, any Open Order units not in Cohesion gain Flee tokens.

Evasion

Spread out and always moving, light troops are hard to pin down with arrows.

While a unit with Evasion is in Open Order and has a Run Action Token, Shooting attacks against it suffer a -1 Accuracy penalty. All Skirmishing Warriors, Light Warriors, Skirmishing Cavalry, and Light Cavalry have Evasion.

Skirmishing Warriors & Light Warriors

Skirmishing Warriors are simply Warriors that are Open Order.

Light Warriors are Warrior units that may be Closed or Open Order. When deploying a Light Warrior unit, the controlling player decides whether to deploy them in a tray as Closed Order or in Cohesion as an Open Order unit.

Additionally, during a game the controlling player may choose to convert a Closed Order unit of Light Warriors into Open Order. During the unit's activation, the unit may spend half of

its Move Allowance to move off of its tray and begin operating as an Open Order unit. Remove the tray once it is convenient.

Skirmishing Warriors and Light Warriors have the Evasion special rule.

Skirmishing Cavalry & Light Cavalry

Skirmishing and Light Cavalry operate as expected - Skirmishing Cavalry are Open Order Cavalry units that use Cohesion, and Light Cavalry units are able to be used as either Open or Closed order, as per the rules for Light Warriors above.

Skirmishing Cavalry and Light Cavalry have the Evasion special rule.

Open Order Chariots and Elephants

There are no Skirmishing or Light Chariots or Elephants available in army profiles, however these units can possibly become Open Order with the use of Special Abilities. While Open Order, Chariot and Elephant units split up and each model is treated as its own Open Order unit.

Warmachines

Warmachine units are war engines, such as bolt throwers and stone throwers, crewed by Engineers. Engineers are Open Order models and must stay within 1" Cohesion of their war engine. Every Warmachine unit is a Light, Heavy, or Massive Warmachine, which decides how its war engine moves. All Warmachine units follow these rules:

Crewed

A war engine can only move or shoot while at least 2 of its Engineers are within 1" of it.

Protected Engine

A war engine cannot be targeted by Shooting attacks or attacked in Melee. Attacks against a Warmachine unit are made against its Engineers. The war engine cannot be Bumped, Pushed, or moved through, but its Engineers can be Bumped as normal.

Light Warmachines

A Light Warmachine may move and shoot in the same activation, but cannot Run or Charge.

Heavy Warmachines

A Heavy Warmachine may either move or shoot in an activation, not both, and cannot Run or Charge.

Massive Warmachines

A Massive Warmachine cannot move once it has been deployed.

Abandoned War Engines

If all of a war engine's Engineers are destroyed or have a Flee Action Token, the war engine is abandoned. An abandoned war engine stays where it is and cannot move or shoot, but still blocks movement and Line of Sight as a battlefield object. An abandoned war engine counts as a Flammable Obstacle, and it can only be destroyed by fire, such as from Fire Brands. Moving into base contact with it does not destroy it. Abandoned war engines count as destroyed at the end of the game.

Recovering War Engines

Engineers can recover an abandoned war engine, including one from an enemy army. If at least 2 Engineer models from a unit without a war engine of its own end their movement in base contact with an abandoned war engine, the war engine joins their unit and is no longer abandoned. Only Engineer models can recover a war engine.

Special Characters

General Special Characters

Birdmaster

Models upgraded to Birdmaster provide 1 additional point to the Army Morale.

If this unit is deployed via the Scout special rule, after the unit is placed, the opponent reveals to the controlling player 1 Command Card they **did not** pick, at random.

Bowmaster

Models upgraded to Bowmaster provide 1 additional point to the Army Morale.

The upgraded model grants the unit the Aim special rule.

They also contribute one extra attack for Shooting, but **not** for Combat.

Houndmaster

Models upgraded to Houndmaster provide 1 additional point to the Army Morale.

The unit containing the Houndmaster inflicts Army Morale equal to its base Training to the defending army when they charge, before Break Tests would be made.

Additionally, enemy units may **not be deployed** within 12" of this unit during deployment.

Lead Captain

Models upgraded to Lead Captain provide additional points equal to their Training value to the Army Morale.

They also contribute one extra attack for Combat or Shooting.

Lord

Models upgraded to Lord provide additional points equal to three times their Training value to the Army Morale.

The model grants the unit the Noble special rule.

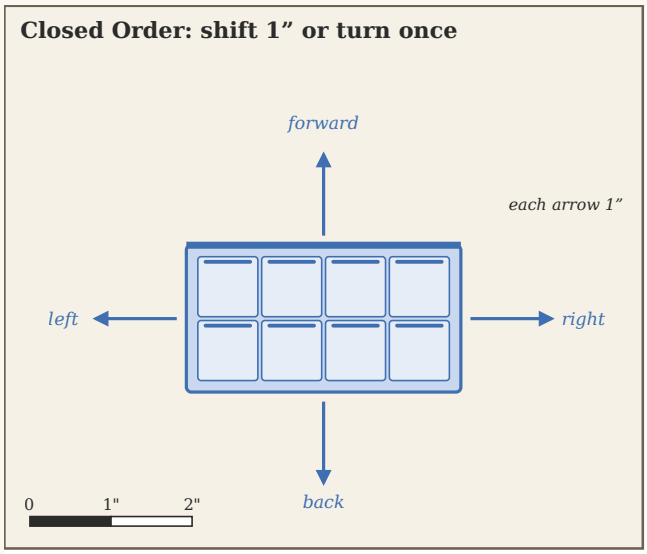
While the Lord's unit is fleeing, the controlling player loses this model's Training value in Army Morale each round. When this unit is eliminated, the controlling player loses this model's Training Value in Army Morale, and each opponent gains that much in Army Morale.

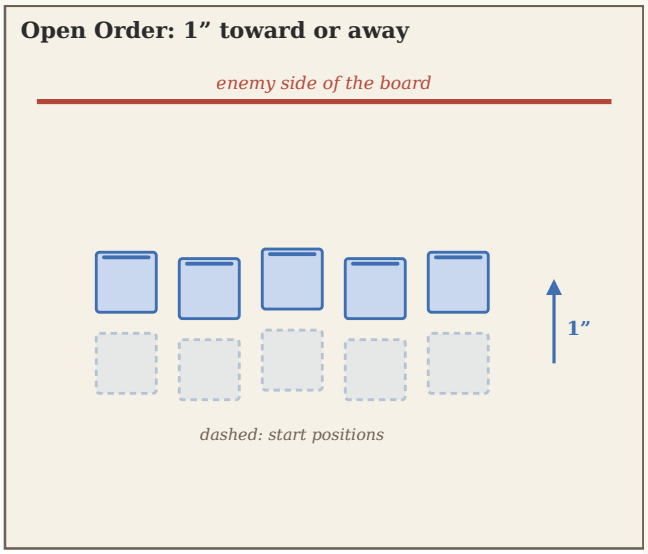
Musician

Models upgraded to Musician provide 3 additional points to the Army Morale.

The Musician grants the unit the ability to shift their position with a Special Move if they do not have an Action Token and they are not Locked in Combat. At the end of the unit's Movement Step, they perform a Special Move depending on if they are an Open Order or Closed Order unit.

If the unit is Closed Order it may Special Move directly forward, backwards, left, or right 1" without changing facing, or it may turn once. If the unit is Open Order, they move 1" along the route quickest towards or away from the enemy side of the board. They **may not** begin or end this shift in position within 1" of any enemy unit. This is considered movement. This Character has a special interaction with the Commander Special Character.





The Musician's Special Move

At the end of its Movement Step, a unit with a Musician that has no Action Token and is not Locked in Combat may make a Special Move. A Closed Order unit shifts 1" straight forward, back, left or right without changing facing, or turns once. An Open Order unit moves 1" by the quickest route toward or away from the enemy side of the board. It may not begin or end within 1" of an enemy.

When this unit is eliminated, the controlling player loses this model's Training Value in Army Morale, and each opponent gains that much in Army Morale.

Ranger Captain

Models upgraded to Ranger Captain provide 2 additional points to the Army Morale.

Ranger Captains grant the Surefooted special rule to their unit.

Rear Captain

Models upgraded to Rear Captain provide additional points equal to their Training value to the Army Morale.

The unit gains a +2 bonus to Break Tests, and a +2 bonus to Rally Tests when attempting to Rally itself.

Shaman

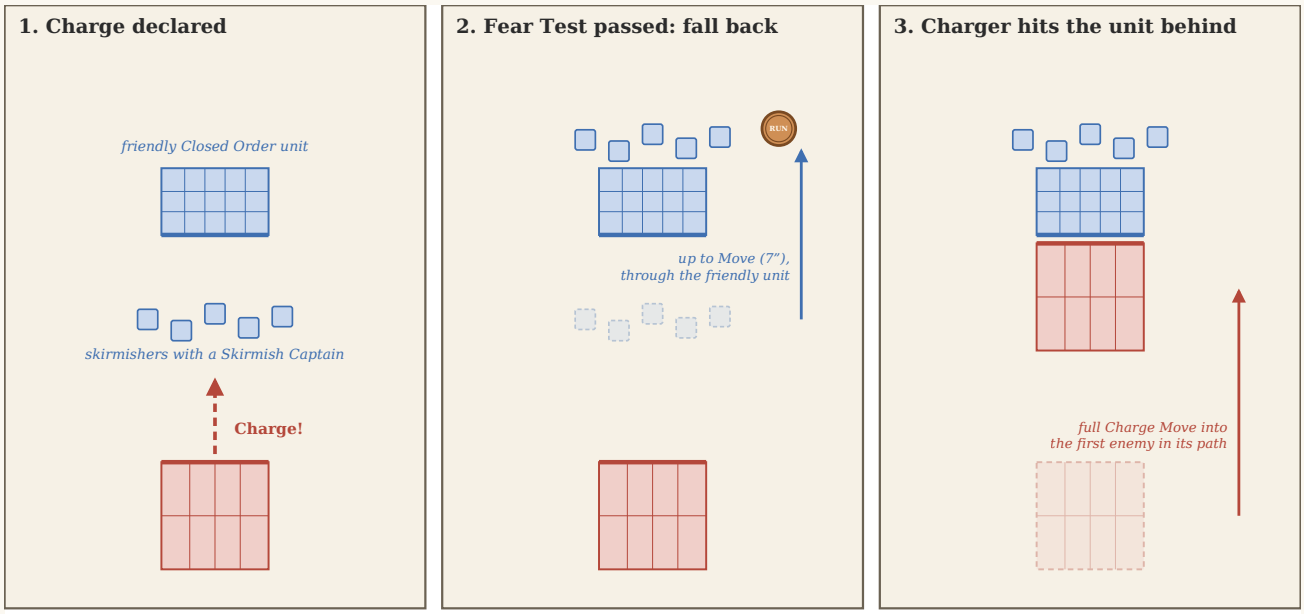
Models upgraded to Shaman provide 3 additional points to the Army Morale.

Shamans grant the Frenzy special rule to their unit.

Skirmish Captain

Models upgraded to Skirmish Captain provide 1 additional point to the Army Morale.

When an enemy unit declares a Charge against this unit, before measuring, this unit may take a Fear Test. If it passes, it falls back: move it directly away from the charging unit up to its Move value. While falling back it may move through allied units, but may not end its move on or touching them, or within 1" of an enemy unit. It then gains a Run Action Token. The charging unit then measures as normal. If it can no longer reach this unit, it may instead charge the first enemy unit in its straight path, using its full Charge Move. If there is none, it moves as far as it can and does not lose Army Morale for a failed charge. If the Fear Test fails, the unit stays where it is and the charge resolves normally.



The Skirmish Captain

When an enemy declares a Charge against a unit with a Skirmish Captain, before measuring, it may take a Fear Test. If it passes, it falls back directly away from the charger up to its Move, through friendly units if needed (not ending on or touching them, or within 1" of an enemy), and gains a Run Token. If the charger can no longer reach it, it may charge the first enemy unit in its path.

Light Warrior units with a Skirmish Captain must be deployed in Open Order.

Standard Bearer

Models upgraded to Standard Bearer provide additional points equal to two times their Training value to the Army Morale. This Character has a special interaction with the Commander Special Character.

While the Standard Bearer's unit is fleeing, the controlling player loses this model's Training value in Army Morale each round. When this unit is eliminated, the controlling player loses this model's Training Value in Army Morale, and each opponent gains that much in Army Morale.

Taskmaster

Models upgraded to Taskmaster provide no additional points to the Army Morale, unlike other special characters.

The upgraded model removes the Levy special rule for the unit.

However, whenever the unit passes a Break or Rally test, it suffers 1 Damage. This Damage has no save and causes Army Morale loss as normal.

Tribal Leader

Models upgraded to Tribal Leader provide 2 additional points to the Army Morale.

The upgraded model grants the unit the Noble special rule, and the unit loses the Levy special rule if it has it.

They also contribute one extra attack for Combat or Shooting.

Volleymaster

Models upgraded to Volleymaster provide 1 additional point to the Army Morale.

The upgraded model grants the unit the Volley special rule.

They also contribute one extra attack for Shooting, but **not** for Combat.

Retinue Special Characters

Army Standard Bearer

Models upgraded to Army Standard Bearer provide additional points equal to four times their Training value to the Army Morale. This Character **does not** have any special interaction with the Commander Special Character.

While this Army Standard Bearer's unit is fleeing, the controlling player loses two times this model's Training value in Army Morale each round. When this unit is eliminated, the controlling player loses two times this model's Training Value in Army Morale, and each opponent gains that much in Army Morale.

This model also grants you a +1 bonus to Initiative Rolls. You may only have 1 of each Retinue Special Character unless otherwise stated.

Army Musician

Models upgraded to Army Musician provide additional points equal to two times their Training value to the Army Morale.

The Army Musician does not affect their units marching like a normal Musician, but instead affects the ferocity of the entire army.

At the end of the Activation Phase, but before Combat, the player controlling the Army Musician may choose to replace all of their units' Hold Action Tokens with Charge Action Tokens, or replace all of their units' Charge Action Tokens with Hold Action Tokens. Should multiple players have Army Musicians, they take turns deciding to use their Army Musicians in Initiative Order.

While this Army Musician's unit is fleeing, the controlling player loses this model's Training value in Army Morale each round. When this unit is eliminated, the controlling player loses this model's Training Value in Army Morale, and each opponent gains that much in Army Morale.

This model also grants you a +1 bonus to Initiative Rolls. You may only have 1 of each Retinue Special Character unless otherwise stated.

Commander

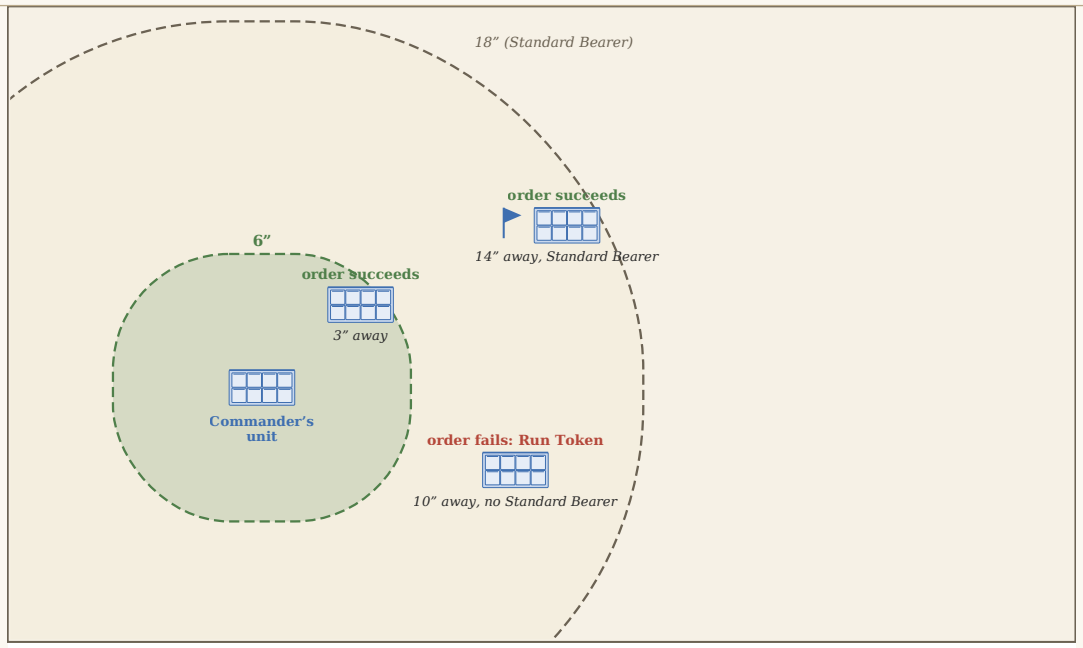
Models upgraded to Commander provide additional points equal to three times their Training value to the Army Morale.

The Commander can order units to make small adjustments to their fighting position, should they not have an Action Token or be Locked in Combat. At the end of any allied unit's Movement Step, a player may choose to activate their Commander. Measure the distance between the chosen unit and the unit with the Commander Special Character.

If the distance is greater than 6", the special ability fails. However, if the selected unit has a Standard Bearer, instead the special ability fails if the distance is greater than 18".

If the special ability fails, give the chosen unit a Run token as it struggles to understand its Commander in the chaos.

If the special ability succeeds, the chosen unit may perform a Special Move depending on if it is an Open Order or Closed Order unit. If the chosen unit is Closed order it may Special Move directly forward, backwards, left, or right 1" without changing facing, or it may turn once. If the chosen unit is Open Order, they move 1" along the route quickest towards or away from the enemy side of the board. This is considered movement. If the chosen unit has a Musician, you may combine this move with the Musician's Special Move, in either order.



The Commander

At the end of an allied unit's Movement Step, the Commander can order it to make a Special Move (1" shift or one turn for Closed Order, 1" toward or away from the enemy side for Open Order), if it has no Action Token and is not Locked in Combat. Measure from the Commander's unit: the order fails beyond 6", or beyond 18" if the chosen unit has a Standard Bearer. A failed order gives a Run Token.

While this Commander's unit is fleeing, the controlling player loses two times this model's Training value in Army Morale each round. When this unit is eliminated, the controlling player loses two times this model's Training Value in Army Morale, and each opponent gains that much in Army Morale.

This model also grants you a +1 bonus to Initiative Rolls. You may only have 1 of each Retinue Special Character unless otherwise stated.

Special Rules

Some special rules have a number written as (X). When the same rule applies to a unit or weapon from more than one source, the numbers add together (see Priority and Ability Interactions).

Model Special Rules

Aim

Taking time for just the right moment, expert archers can focus on hitting just the right target

If the unit takes the Hold action, they may choose to use Aim to add a +1 bonus to their Shooting attacks this round. Additionally, they ignore the penalty caused by Light Cover.

Units **may not** use Aim during the same round they use the Volley special rule.

Ambush

Ambushers lie in wait for their target, to bring them down quickly before fleeing

During deployment, units with Ambush are deployed after all other units, including Scouting units, and after all deployment Byes. After all units without Ambush have been deployed, and all Byes have been used, the player who had the most Byes decides who deploys all of their Ambushing Units first. In the case of a tie, roll off, with the player with the greater result deciding who deploys all of their Ambushing Units first.

Ambushing units deployed this way **cannot** be deployed in their own deployment zone, and instead are deployed anywhere else on the board, as long as they are deployed within 12" of an enemy unit.

Disciplined

Drilled and steady, they hold their ground and do not chase shadows.

This unit cannot be Bumped or Pushed, so a Charge whose path it blocks fails. It automatically passes the special Break Test from Feign Retreat, though it may still choose to be goaded.

Open Order units with this special ability only gain these effects while every model in the unit is within 1" Cohesion of at least 3 other models in their unit.

Feign Charge

Fear is the strongest weapon of the cavalry soldier, only striking when the foe is shaken

When a unit declares a Charge, they may declare it to be a Feign Charge instead before measuring. Unlike a normal charge, a Feign Charge requires that the attacking unit be within its Move value to the defending unit. If it is not, the Feign Charge fails like any other Charge (see Charge Fails). Execute the instructions for a Charge for this unit, except that it only gets Move Allowance equal to one times its Move Value.

After making contact with the defender, the enemy loses Army Morale equal to the attacking unit's Unit Strength. Then, if the defending unit would take a Break Test (for Terrify, or due to size of the attacking unit), they now take it.

Then finally, the attacking unit moves away. If it is a Closed Order unit, rotate the unit 180 degrees. Move the attacking unit as far as possible up to half its Move value in any direction, while keeping the unit at least 1" from any enemy unit. The attacking unit may not turn while executing this move. The attacking unit may not choose to take a shorter path should a longer one be possible. Place a Charge token next to the attacking unit as it is considered to have charged.

Feign Retreat

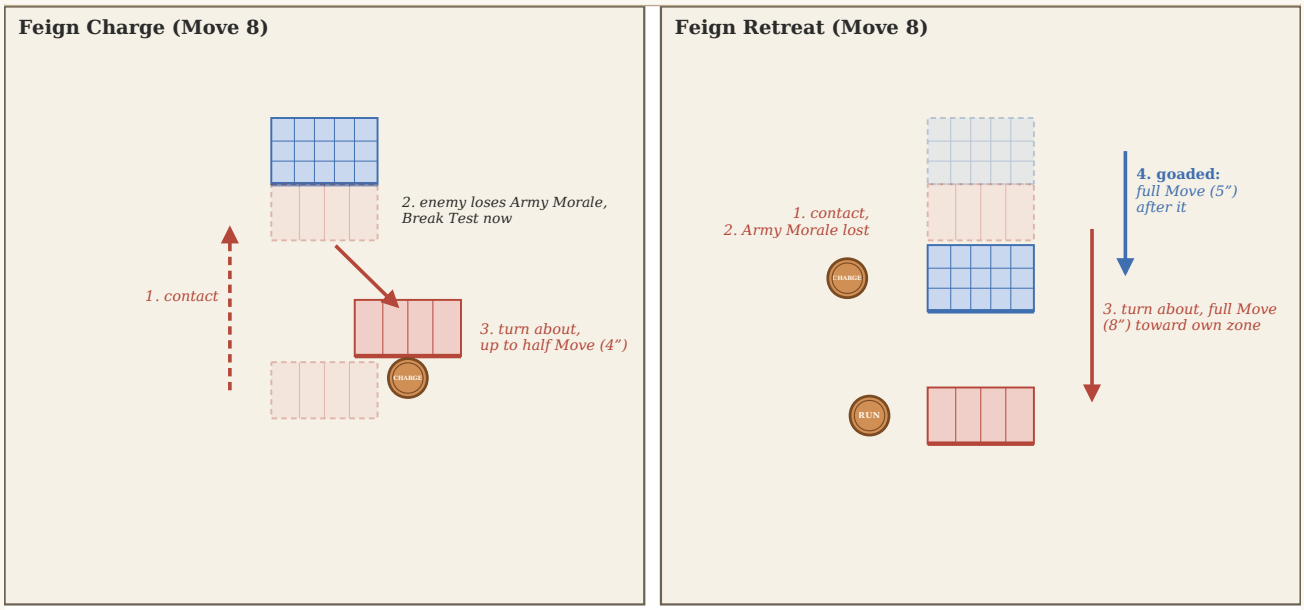
Feigning weakness is sometimes more effective than feigning strength.

When a unit declares a Charge, they may declare it to be a Feign Retreat instead before measuring. Unlike a normal charge, a Feign Retreat requires that the attacking unit be within its Move value to the defending unit. If it is not, the Feign Retreat fails like any other Charge (see Charge Fails). Execute the instructions for a Charge for this unit, except that it only gets Move Allowance equal to one times its Move Value.

Before the defending unit would take a Break Test, the enemy loses Army Morale equal to the attacking unit's Unit Strength. Then, if the defending unit would take a Break Test (for Terrify, or due to size of the attacking unit), they do not take one yet.

Next, the attacking unit pretends to flee. If it is a Closed Order unit, rotate the unit 180 degrees. Move the attacking unit as close as possible toward its own deployment zone with its full Move value, while keeping the unit at least 1" from any enemy unit. The attacking unit may not turn while executing this move. The attacking unit may not choose to move to a destination further from its own deployment zone should a closer destination be possible. Place a Run token next to the attacking unit as it is considered to have ran.

And finally, the enemy takes a special Break Test. If they fail it, they are goaded; if they pass it, they may choose to be goaded anyway. Rather than fleeing, a goaded defending unit moves forward its full Move value toward the attacking unit, but also such that they are at least 1" from any enemy unit. The defending unit may not move less than its move value in this goaded move. Place a Charge token next to the defending unit - it cannot move or run during its activation this round if it has not yet activated (if it already has, there is no further effect), and may only use missile weapons which it can use without penalty while moving (even though it has a Charge token).



Feign Charge and Feign Retreat

Both are declared instead of a Charge, before measuring, and need the target within the unit's Move. The unit makes contact and the enemy loses 1 Army Morale per warrior and 3 per cavalry model. Feign Charge: any Break Test happens now, then the unit turns about and moves up to half its Move away, ending with a Charge Token. Feign Retreat: it turns about and moves its full Move toward its own deployment zone, ending with a Run Token; the enemy then takes a special Break Test and, if goaded, moves its full Move after it.

Frenzy

Wild and animal-like, these crazed soldiers leap into the fray with reckless abandon

Units with Frenzy **do not lose** their Charge Action Token when charged by units with greater Unit Strength.

They do not gain Break tokens from units with the Terrify special rule.

They gain a +2 bonus on Break Tests and Fear Tests.

Guard

These well trained warriors are experts at small arms combat, and utilizing a few elite groups to maximize their potential.

When a unit with the Guard special rule would begin activation with a Hold token, that unit may instead swap its Order Token with another unit within 12" that has not yet activated this round. If they do, remove the Guard unit's Hold Token.

Levy

The only training a levy soldier may have is this current battle, and they would prefer for it to not be their last

Closed Order units with the Levy special rule **do not count** their rear rank when determining Unit Strength, unless the unit has only one rank. Open Order units with the Levy special rule divide their Unit Strength by 2, rounded up.

While the army is suffering from Mass Panic, units with this rule automatically fail Break Tests and **cannot** be Rallied.

Mercenary

Mercenaries are professional soldiers who are well trained but aren't planning on dying for their customers

Units with the Mercenary special rule may Rally themselves as normal, but cannot be Rallied by other units, except by units with the Noble Special Rule, or units with the Mercenary special rule and a greater base Training value. Additionally, this unit **cannot** Rally units other than Mercenaries.

While the army is suffering from Mass Panic, units with this rule automatically fail Break Tests and **cannot** be Rallied.

Mixed Unit

Mixed Units represent forces that combined different types of equipment at the squad level of an army

Unlike other units, Mixed Units can have different combinations of Equipment and Gear per model in a unit, according to the restrictions on the unit profile. Apply all other rules to Mixed Units, such as equipment use restrictions, movement penalties, and so on. If the unit is composed of models with different Armor Saves, use the most common

Armor Save present, or the weaker Armor Save if tied. If models have different Move penalties from their Gear and Equipment, the whole unit uses the largest penalty.

Noble

Wealthy lords and nobles of times past often fought side by side with their soldiers, or so the history books say

Noble units gain +2 bonus when Rallying other units, and may Rally Mercenary units.

Mercenary and Levy units within 24" are able to be Rallied while suffering Mass Panic.

Parthian Shot

The steppe nomads were not just expert horse archers, but also experts in psychological warfare

After executing a Feign Retreat, units with Parthian Shot may use missile weapons to perform Shooting attacks, even though they have a Run token. They may only select the unit they used Feign Retreat on as the target of their shooting this round. The attacking unit incurs a -2 penalty when making these Shooting attacks.

Phalanx

A well trained band of men fighting in a tight formation of shields and spears is quite difficult to overwhelm

Units with the Phalanx special rule confer a -1 penalty to rolls for Shooting and Melee Hits targeting them (not -1 penalty to Accuracy). Units in a Phalanx take a -1 penalty to their Move value. Units that declare a charge against a Phalanx gain a Break Token unless the attacking unit has a melee weapon with a greater Length than the Phalanx unit's longest melee weapon.

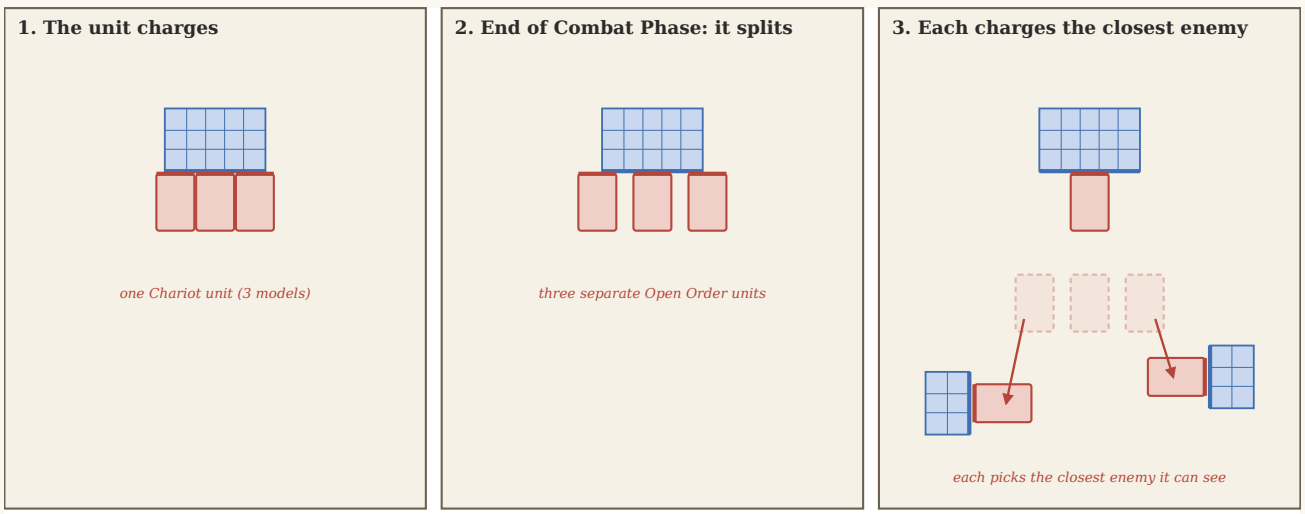
The Phalanx ability can be negated for several reasons:

- The Unit is standing in certain types of Terrain
- The Unit is at Half Strength, or less than 6 Models
- The Unit has neither a Shield nor a weapon with Length 6 or greater

Run Them Down

Unit splits up and charges every round after charging once or being charged

The first time this unit charges or is charged, at the end of that Combat Phase it splits apart: each model becomes its own Open Order unit. From then on, each model must declare a Charge at the start of its activation against the closest enemy unit it can see. If it cannot reach that unit, it Runs toward it instead. Its controlling player does not lose Army Morale for these forced Charges failing. Elephant models instead target the closest unit they can see, friend or foe. These models cannot Hold, Flee, or Rally, and automatically pass Break Tests. This lasts until the model is destroyed. If an Elephant model charges a friendly unit, treat that unit as an enemy for the charge and the Melee that follows.



Run Them Down

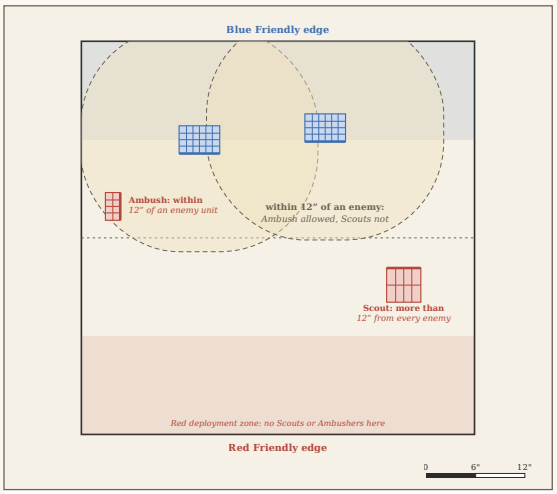
The first time a unit with Run Them Down charges or is charged, at the end of that Combat Phase it splits up: every model becomes its own Open Order unit. From then on, each one must declare a Charge against the closest enemy unit it can see at the start of its activation, or Run toward it if it cannot reach. They cannot Hold, Flee or Rally. Elephants target the closest unit, friend or foe.

Scout

Scouts can deploy ahead of the main force to harass the enemy safely

During deployment, units with Scout are deployed after units without Scout or Ambush, and after all deployment Byes. After all units without Scout or Ambush have been deployed, and all Byes have been used, the player who had the most Byes decides who deploys all of their Scouting units first. In the case of a tie, roll off, with the player with the greater result deciding who deploys all of their Scouting Units first.

Scouting units deployed this way **cannot** be deployed in their own deployment zone, and instead are deployed anywhere else on the board, as long as they **are not** deployed within 12" of an enemy model.



Scout and Ambush

Scouting and Ambushing units deploy after everyone else, and never in their own deployment zone. A Scout may be placed anywhere else as long as it is not within 12" of an enemy model. An Ambusher may be placed anywhere else as long as it is within 12" of an enemy unit. Scouts deploy before Ambushers, so an Ambush can answer where the Scouts went.

Shieldwall

Locked shield to shield, these warriors present a wall that is hard to break.

While this unit has a Hold Action Token, attacks against it suffer a -1 Accuracy penalty.

Suicidal

Some warriors train with diabolical intent, to deploy their warmachine or even themselves to be thrown into the fray with reckless abandon

Units with the Suicidal special rule **are not removed** due to Damage until the end of the Combat Phase, even if the Unit Health Table would have them removed.

Surefooted

Born to rough country, these warriors cross broken ground where others stumble.

This unit ignores the penalties of Difficult Terrain. Within a Stony Plain, it moves as if it were Skirmishing Warriors. Within a Marsh, its Move Allowance is limited to its Move Value as normal, but it does not gain Break Tokens from moving there.

Surefooted (X): As Surefooted, but only within terrain of the listed types: Stony Plain, Marsh, or Sand. A unit may list more than one, e.g. Surefooted (Marsh, Sand). Terrain that follows the rules for a type counts as that type, so Crumbled Ruins count as Stony Plain, and Flooded Fields and Chinampas count as Marsh.

Tactician

The art of war demands a careful hand to craft the finest results.

Units with the Tactician special rule grant a +1 bonus to Initiative rolls while the unit has a Hold token. If you have multiple units with this special rule, the bonus **does not stack**.

Terrify X

Their heart stops, their eyes open widely - their greatest fear has appeared.

Units with this special rule have a special interaction with units of type "X". When this unit charges or is charged by a unit with the type "X," that unit gains a Break Token. A unit of type "X" that this unit successfully Bumps during a Charge also gains a Break Token. Units with Terrify All have this interaction with every unit type.

Volley

Letting loose a volley of arrows will break the enemy before they even approach

If the unit takes the Hold action, they may choose to use Volley. That unit's Shooting attacks this round have twice their typical range, at -1 Accuracy and -1 Strength. The unit fires over the heads of its own army: friendly units do not prevent it from shooting, and it reduces the level of Cover against its attacks by one step (Heavy Cover becomes Cover, Cover becomes Light Cover, and Light Cover becomes No Cover). Cannot Shoot is not reduced.

Units may not use Volley during the same round they use the Aim special rule.

Weapon Special Rules

Cleaving Blade (X)

This weapon excels at destroying lightly armored foes, but strong armor and shields blunt its attacks

This weapon gains +2 Strength, unless the target's Armor Value is X or greater. Against Elephants, this weapon always gains +2 Strength. Check the target's Armor Value at the time of the attack (see Armor Value).

Cumbersome

Heavy engines take time to aim, and a darting target is gone before the shot is loosed.

When this weapon targets a unit whose Evasion applies, it suffers an additional -1 Accuracy. This stacks with the Evasion penalty and with any effects that increase it.

Direct Fire

The target is right in your sights, and up close your shot hits your target with all its strength.

While attacking targets within a quarter of your maximum range, attacks with this weapon gains +1 Strength.

Massive Suppression (X)

A single great bolt or stone can break the nerve of a whole battle line.

Each Hit with this weapon makes the defending player lose X Army Morale from Suppression, instead of 1.

Melee Suppression

Every blow that lands shakes the resolve of the line, whether or not it draws blood.

Each Hit with this weapon in Melee causes the defending player to lose 1 Army Morale from Suppression, just as a Shooting Hit does. Effects that increase, reduce or negate Suppression also apply to Melee Suppression.

Parrying Blade

While some swords are merely brutish instruments to be chopped at an enemy, many blades could be used equally in offense and defense

This weapon provides +1 Armor Save while in Melee while the unit has a Hold Action Token.

Pavise

Planted side by side, great shields turn a formation into a wall.

When this unit takes the Hold action, it may plant its Pavise. While planted, Shooting attacks against this unit from its front arc treat it as one cover level better (No Cover becomes Light Cover, Light Cover becomes Cover, and Cover becomes Heavy Cover), and enemy units that charge it in its front arc do not gain any Strength bonuses from having a Charge Action Token. The Pavise is picked up as soon as the unit moves for any reason other than an Alignment turn.

Piercing Shot (X)

Heavy bolts can pass through one man and strike the next.

Against a Closed Order unit, each successful Hit with this weapon causes X additional Hits on the same unit.

Reach (X)

Long spears and pikes let the men behind the front rank strike past their comrades.

Models up to X ranks behind the front rank of a Closed Order unit using this weapon also make Melee attacks. For example, with Reach (1) the second rank also attacks, and with Reach (2) the second and third ranks attack.

Recurve Bow

Built from horn, wood, and sinew, these compact bows strike far harder than their size suggests

This weapon's Direct Fire special rule applies to targets within half of its maximum range, instead of a quarter.

Sunder (X)

Some blows land so hard that no armor can turn them aside.

Enemies roll Armor Saves at a -X Penalty against attacks made with this weapon.

Throwing Weapon

The staple of the ancient age, throwing weapons are flexible and fearsome tools of war

Shooting attacks made with Throwing Weapons ignore the "Attacker moved" penalty.

Units that are Locked in Combat and have a Hold token may use Throwing Weapons to make Shooting attacks against enemy units they are Locked in Combat with, at a -3 Accuracy penalty. While making attacks this way the unit may not use the Aim or Volley Special Abilities.

Thrusting Blade

When used in the hands of an expert, these swords could slip between shields and armor to hit their mark.

Enemies roll Armor Saves at -1 Penalty while the unit does not have a Flee, Charge, or Run Action Token.

Unwieldy (X)

Long weapons make for a slow and clumsy wheel.

Each turn made by a Closed Order unit equipped with this weapon or armor costs an additional X" of its Move Allowance, including the Alignment turn made before a Charge. Open Order units equipped with this weapon or armor suffer -X Move instead.

Gear and Equipment

This section covers how armor and shields protect a model. For the difference between Equipment and Gear, see Gear, Equipment, and Upgrades.

Armor Value

A model's Armor Value is the sum of its Body Armor, its Shield, its Barding, and its Unit Type's Armor Modifier (see Unit Types). Elephants are the exception: their Armor Value is always 3 (see Great Toughness). Armor Value is always checked at the moment an attack is made, using every bonus and penalty in effect at that time, such as a Shield's bonus while the unit has a Hold Action Token, or a Heavy Shield's penalty while the unit has a Run or Flee Action Token. Weapon special rules that check the target's Armor, such as Cleaving Blade (X), use this value.

Some armor and shields change their Armor bonus depending on the Strength of the attack, such as the Persian Spara and the Aztec Chīmalli and Ichcahuipilli, which give 1 less Armor against weapons of Strength 6 or greater. These always check the attacking weapon's profile Strength, ignoring any bonus from Cleaving Blade (X) and all other Strength modifiers.

Body Armor

Armor	Armor Value	Move Penalty	Special Ability
Light Armor	1	0	
Medium Armor	2	0	-1 Armor while the unit has a Run or Flee Action Token
Heavy Armor	3	-1	Unwieldy (1). -1 Armor while the unit has a Run or Flee Action Token
Barding	1	-1	Horse armor, Cavalry only. Stacks with the rider's Body Armor and Shield

Shields

Shield	Armor Value	Move Penalty	Special Ability
Buckler	0	0	+1 Armor against Melee attacks
Shield	1	0	+1 Armor while the unit has a Hold Action Token
Heavy Shield	2	-1	+1 Armor while the unit has a Hold Action Token. -1 Armor while the unit has a Run or Flee Action Token

Priority and Ability Interactions

When several abilities or effects would happen at the same time, the active player chooses the order they resolve in. During a unit's activation, the player activating that unit is the active player. Outside of a unit's activation, the player or team that is first in Initiative order chooses the order.

Stacking Values. When a unit, model or weapon has the same special rule with a number (X) from more than one source, add the numbers together. For example, a weapon with Unwieldy (1), used by a unit that also has Unwieldy (1) from another source, has Unwieldy (2). Rules without a number, such as Disciplined, do not stack: having one twice is the same as having it once.

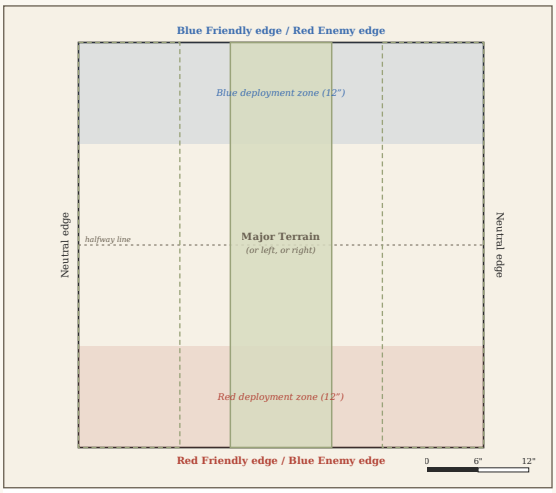
Setting Up

Before each battle, players set up in this order:

1. **The Battlefield:** set up the board.
2. **The First Player:** compare points bids to decide who is the First Player.
3. **Major Terrain:** the First Player chooses either its type or its location, and the other player makes the remaining choice.
4. **Command Hands:** each player secretly picks 3 of their 6 Command cards.
5. **Terrain Features:** starting with the First Player, players place terrain features from their Command cards.
6. **Deployment:** players deploy their armies, then Scouting and Ambushing units. Some units may wait in Reserve.

The Battlefield

Standard games are played on a 4' x 4' board, and 2v2 games on a 4' x 6' board. Each player's own board edge is their Friendly board edge, the opposing edge is the Enemy board edge, and the remaining two are Neutral board edges. In 2v2 games, teammates share a Friendly board edge.



The Battlefield

A standard game is played on a 4' x 4' board. Each player's own edge is their Friendly board edge; the side edges are Neutral. Deployment zones extend 12" from each Friendly edge. The Major Terrain, a 1' x 4' strip on this board, runs between the two players' edges along the left, down the centre, or along the right; the First Player chooses its location or its type.

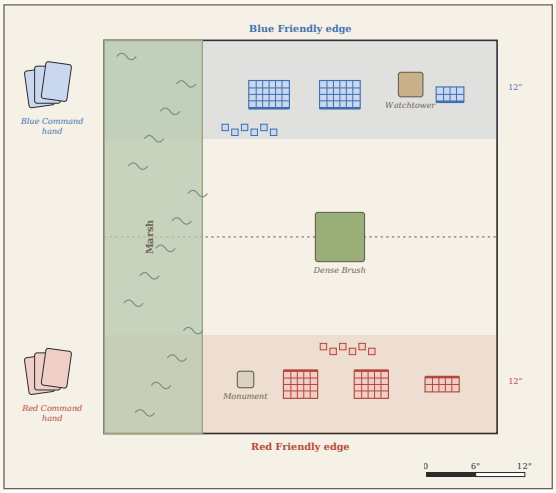
The First Player

Players may build armies below the points limit in a bid to become the First Player. Each player's bid is the number of points their army is below the limit, up to a maximum of 25 points. Points below the limit beyond that do not add to the bid. The player with the higher bid is the First Player. If the bids are tied, the players roll off, and the winner is the First Player.

For example, in a 2000 point game, an army of 1999 points bids 1 point and an army of 1940 points bids 25 points, so the 1940 point army's player is the First Player. If the armies were 1940 and 1975 points, both bids would be 25 points, so the players would roll off.

In 2v2 games, each team adds its two armies together and compares the total against the combined points limit, with the same 25 point maximum bid.

Terrain



A Battlefield Ready to Play
A 4' x 4' board after Setting Up. The Major Terrain (here a Marsh) runs along the left edge. Terrain features from Command cards are placed: a Watchtower in Blue's deployment zone, Dense Brush in the neutral middle and a Monument by Red. Each army is deployed wholly within its 12" zone, Closed Order units facing the enemy edge, and each player's 3-card Command hand waits beside the board.

Major Terrain

Every battle has one Major Terrain: a 1' x 4' strip on the standard 4' x 4' board, or a 2' x 4' strip on the 4' x 6' board used for 2v2 games. It can be represented by a piece of felt. Before players pick their Command hands, the First Player chooses either the Major Terrain's location or its type, and the other player makes the remaining choice.

The Major Terrain runs between the two players' board edges, placed along the left edge, along the right edge, or down the center of the board. On smaller boards, the players should agree on any adjustments.

Difficult Terrain

While a unit is within Difficult Terrain:

- It does not gain +1 Strength from a Charge Action Token
- It does not gain +1 Accuracy from a Hold Action Token

Major Terrain Types

Each type of Major Terrain brings its own hardships, and some troops suffer far more than others.

Stony Plain

Large rocks dot the windswept landscape, making traversal difficult for most.

- Difficult Terrain
- If any part of a unit's move enters or crosses a Stony Plain, its Move Allowance for that whole move cannot exceed its Move Value, so a Run or Charge covers no more ground than a Standard Move. Skirmishing Warrior units are exempt
- Chariots, Elephants, and Warmachines gain a Break Token and suffer 1 hit at Strength 4 every time any movement has them move within a Stony Plain
- The following abilities are negated while within a Stony Plain:
  - Feign Charge
  - Feign Retreat
  - Phalanx
  - Shieldwall
  - Pavise
  - Reach
  - Collision

Marsh

Swampy wetlands bog down all soldiers, and stop wheeled vehicles dead.

- Difficult Terrain
- If any part of a unit's move enters or crosses a Marsh, its Move Allowance for that whole move cannot exceed its Move Value, so a Run or Charge covers no more ground than a Standard Move. This applies even to Skirmishing Warrior units
- Chariots, Elephants, and Warmachines gain a Break Token every time any movement has them move within a Marsh
- If an Elephant unit begins its activation wholly within a Marsh, it gains a Break Token and suffers a 50% movement penalty
- If a Chariot or Warmachine unit begins its activation wholly within a Marsh, it gains 4 Break Tokens. It cannot move unless it is in base contact with a Closed Order unit with greater Unit Strength, in which case it suffers a 50% movement penalty instead
- The following abilities are negated while within a Marsh:
  - Feign Charge
  - Feign Retreat
  - Phalanx
  - Shieldwall
  - Testūdō
  - Pavise
  - Reach
  - Collision

Sand

The shifting sand beneath the warriors' feet makes it difficult to gather much momentum or stand your ground.

- Difficult Terrain

Terrain Features

All terrain features other than the Major Terrain are placed on the battlefield by Command cards. See Commands. Some of these cards are marked Obstacle: structures and growth that a determined crew can tear down, fill in or clear, such as walls, trenches, traps, towers, monuments and brush. Effects such as Sappers can cancel an Obstacle card before its feature is placed. Terrain cards that change the ground itself, such as Crumbled Ruins, Flooded Fields, Chinampas and Prepared Ground, are not Obstacles and cannot be cancelled this way. Some Obstacles are also marked Flammable, such as wooden towers, brush and wagons; effects such as Fire Brands can burn them during the battle.

Command Hands and Terrain Features

After the Major Terrain has been set, each player secretly picks 3 of the 6 cards in their Command deck as their hand (see Commands). Then, starting with the First Player, players take turns playing Command cards from their hands that place terrain features, one card at a time, until neither player wishes to place any more. Cards that respond to these, such as Sappers, may be played as they come up. Once all terrain is placed, players proceed to Deployment.

Deployment

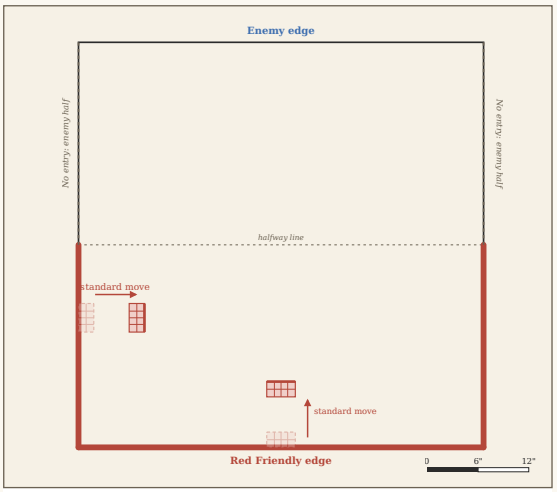
Each player's deployment zone extends 12" from their Friendly board edge. Units must be deployed wholly within their deployment zone, unless a special rule such as Scout or Ambush says otherwise. Closed Order units must be deployed facing straight ahead, toward the Enemy board edge.

Players deploy one unit at a time, taking turns. Before deployment, each player counts the units they will deploy this way, not counting units held in Reserve or units with Scout or Ambush. The player with fewer units gains Byes equal to the difference. The First Player deploys first. On any of their deployment turns, a player may use a Bye to skip that turn instead of deploying a unit.

Reserves

A player may hold up to 25% of their army's points in Reserve instead of deploying them. Reserve units cannot enter the battlefield until the Reserves Phase of the second round, and must be deployed by the Reserves Phase of the fourth round or they are destroyed. When deployed, a Reserve unit is placed along its Friendly board edge, or along either Neutral board edge within its own half of the battlefield. It then makes a standard move before Order Tokens are placed (see Reserves). This move is not a Charge or a Run, since the unit has no Action Token yet, and the unit cannot shoot.

Units in Reserve are not on the battlefield. They cannot use abilities or be targeted, and they do not count toward any Command card or rule that requires that unit. If a player has no units on the battlefield at the end of any Phase, they lose the battle, even if they still have units in Reserve.



Reserves

From the second round, a Reserve unit may enter along its Friendly board edge, or along either Neutral edge within its own half of the battlefield (the thick red lines), never in the enemy's half. It then makes a standard move: not a Charge or a Run, since it has no Action Token yet, and it cannot shoot. Reserves that have not arrived by the fourth round are destroyed.

2v2 Games

In 2v2 games, teammates take their turns at the same time. Each player builds their own Command deck of 6 cards and picks their own hand of 3. Teammates' units count as friendly to each other, so they can Rally each other's units and affect each other with their abilities. Each player may include their own Retinue Special Characters, so a team may field two Commanders, two Army Musicians, and two Army Standard Bearers.

Building an Army

List Making

To build an army, first choose one of the Army Lists. Then select units from that list, following its restrictions on units, up to the agreed points value. Standard games are 2000 points per side, or 1250 points per player in 2v2 games. Each player also builds a Command deck of 6 cards (see Commands).

Every model in a unit must have the same Loadout unless its profile says otherwise (see Gear, Equipment, and Upgrades). Outside of special scenarios, an army may include only one of each Retinue Special Character. Units from the Supplemental Mercenaries list can only be added to an army through Command cards.

Trays, Scale, and Representation

Syrrhēxis is designed for 1/72 scale miniatures, using the base sizes listed in Physical Aspects of a Model.

Trays

Closed Order units are placed on trays sized to hold their models in the ranks and files of their Unit Composition. Because trays from different makers vary, a tray may have a border of up to ¼" (6mm) on each side. Movement and charges are measured from the edge of the tray, as described in Movement. A tray has four edges: its front edge is the one its models face, along its first rank; the opposite edge is its rear edge; and the two edges between them are its left and right flank edges. A unit's flanks and rear are these edges, and they matter for charges, Exposed Flanks, and Collision.

Bases

Closed Order models use the square and rectangular bases listed in Physical Aspects of a Model. Open Order models may use those bases, or round or oval bases instead. A round or oval base must be at least as wide as the listed base, and no longer than the listed base's diagonal. For example, an Open Order Warrior may use a round base from 20mm to 28mm across.

Representation

Each model should show the Equipment on its profile, so that both players can tell units apart at a glance. Gear does not need to be shown. Special Character models do not need to show their Equipment, but should be clearly recognizable as Special Characters, for example with a distinct pose, banner, or instrument.

Army Lists

The army lists themselves are published separately: in each army's deck, and in the online list builder at https://kevinstanzione.github.io/Syrrhexis-Ancient-Battles/

Imperial Rome

Classical Greece

Achaemenid Persia

Hittite Empire

Armies of Alexander

Aztec Empire

Neo-Assyrian Empire

Dynastic Egypt

Sumerian Kingdom

European Barbarians

Kingdom of Kush

Qin China

Hannibal's Forces

Mauryan Empire

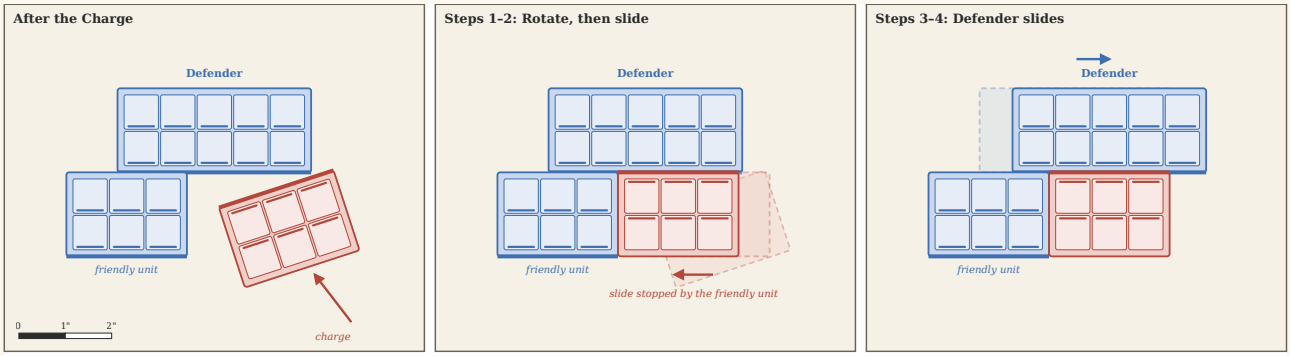
Note. Supplemental Mercenaries is not an army list, and cannot be chosen as your army. Its units can only be added to an army through Command Cards.

Appendix I: Combat Diagrams

Please use this section as a visual reference for tricky combat movement scenarios that may be confusing

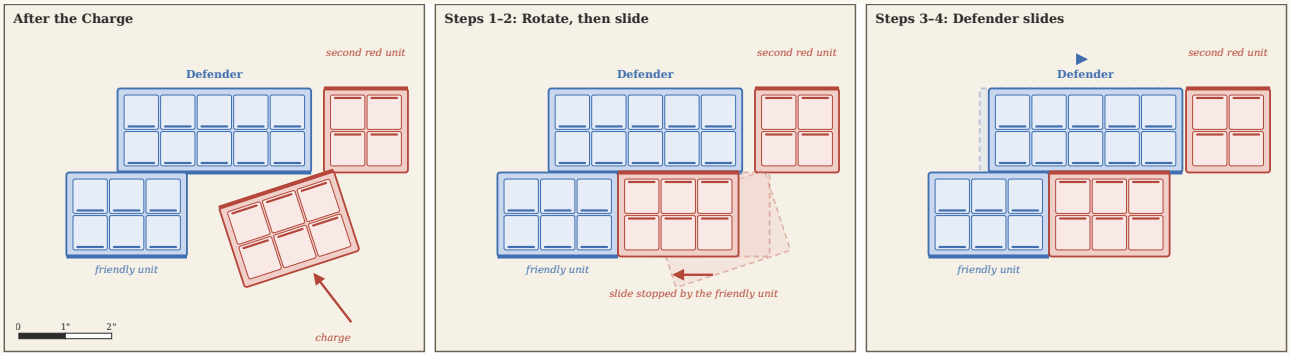
Pile In Diagrams

Pile In Vs Closed Order Diagrams



Pile In: Attacker Blocked

The red attacker charged into the defender's front arc and touched its front corner. It rotates flush (step 1), then slides toward the centre of the defender's front (step 2), but the defender's friendly unit stops it partway. The attacker cannot get centred, so the defender, which is not touching any other enemy unit, slides to centre itself on the attacker (step 4).



Pile In: Both Units Blocked

The same charge, but a second red unit stands beside the defender. The attacker is blocked by the defender's friendly unit as before. The defender slides toward centre but must stop just short of the second red unit, because a Pile In move may never touch any other enemy unit, so that unit does not join the Melee. The two units end flush but not centred, and the Pile In ends there.